A computer-assisted construction of a $c = 8$ Haagerup CFT

Proof manuscript with explicit review obligations

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Abstract

We describe an explicit conformal vertex subalgebra of the lattice VOA $V_{E_6 \oplus A_2}$, generated by an $A_{1,1} \otimes A_{1,39}$ current algebra, the ambient stress tensor, and one three-term lattice field. Exact finite certificates, together with a recursive strong-generation argument, prove that its current space has dimension six. From the stated embedded-field and finite-action inputs we deduce strong rationality, actual lattice branching, and the twelve-component Evans–Gannon character vector with parameter zero. Sector counting and reverse reconstruction give strong unitarity and a completely rational conformal net whose representation category is unitarily ribbon equivalent to the Haagerup center. This yields a diagonal unitary full net theory at $c_L = c_R = 8$. Complete unitarity of the VOA and a chosen $\mathcal{H}_3$ holomorphic VOA extension remain conditional on one explicit geometric annulus comparison. We include fresh exact certificate replays and limited Lean formalizations, with their scopes distinguished from the mathematical arguments and the remaining construction inputs.

HIGH PRIORITY REVIEW — The remaining analytic hypothesis

The net-sector comparison and linear module reconstruction, previously labelled A2 and A3, are proved below from the stated algebraic inputs and cited reconstruction theorems. The annulus comparison A1 remains unproved: the specific geometric operators used by the fusion-positivity theorem must be matched, including their domains and central lifts. The conformal-net realization does not require A1. Complete VOA unitarity and the unitary ribbon identification of $\mathrm{Rep}(U)$ do require it. Exact field identities remain certificate inputs; the finite replays and the narrowly scoped Lean proofs do not verify the entire construction. This is a revised research draft, without external expert validation.

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1 Introduction and statement of results

The Haagerup fusion categories provide a test case for the realization of finite tensor categories by chiral conformal field theory. Their centers are modular, but modular data alone do not construct a vertex operator algebra: the operator products, positivity, and representation theory must be supplied separately. Evans and Gannon computed the relevant modular data and the possible character vectors at central charge eight [2, Sections 2.4 and 5]. In particular, the character with six weight-one states suggests a small current algebra inside a much larger lattice algebra. This observation motivates the construction studied here.

We start with actual vectors in a positive-definite lattice VOA. The ambient vertex operators fix all products and their associativity from the outset. The first substantive problem is then to prove that these vectors generate a proper subalgebra. Generating additional fields in weights two and three does not settle that question: singular products of higher fields could still create new currents. We address this issue by a finite strong-generation criterion. Its input consists of exact normal-product identities and the recursive provenance of the higher generators. Its output controls every conformal weight.

There are three distinct stages. The first constructs the subalgebra and proves properness from explicit finite data. The second uses positive conformal vectors, branching, and fusion-category arguments to analyze its representation theory. The third compares VOA modules with conformal net sectors, proves the net realization, and isolates the remaining condition for complete VOA unitarity. In particular, the existence of a positive vacuum inner product is not substituted for positivity of all fusion pairings.

Our presentation uses the normal-product conventions of De Sole–Kac [1, Section 2], separates character-theoretic information as in Evans–Gannon [2], and states analytic transport hypotheses in the operator-theoretic setting of Carpi–Kawahigashi–Longo–Weiner [3]. These works also guide the level of detail: finite input is recorded as such, and each passage to an infinite-dimensional conclusion is made by a separate lemma. The exact arithmetic certificates are accompanying data, not substitutes for these implications.

1.1 The candidate and its finite construction

Let

$$B = V_{E_6 \oplus A_2}, \qquad H = V_{E_8}, \qquad B \subset H$$

be the standard index-three lattice extension. The notation $A_{1,k}$ means the simple affine VOA $L_k(\mathfrak{sl}_2)$. Fix the embedding $\mathcal{K} = A_{1,1} \otimes A_{1,39} \subset B$ described in Section 2. Let $u \in B_2$ be the field in (8), and define the *actual generated* vertex algebra

$$U = \langle \mathcal{K}, \omega_B, u \rangle \subset B. \tag{1}$$

All products are computed in this lattice VOA. Thus associativity is inherited from the ambient algebra, rather than assumed for an abstract presentation inferred from character coefficients. Throughout the normal-space and mode formulas, $K = \mathcal{K}_1$ denotes only the six-dimensional current space, not the full affine VOA.

Proposition 1.1 (Computational properness conclusion)**.** *Accept the exact lattice identities and provenance recorded in Section A. The algebra U is strongly generated by actual fields of weights at most four. Its weight-one space is*

$$U_1 = \mathfrak{sl}_2 \oplus \mathfrak{sl}_2, \qquad \dim U_1 = 6.$$

Consequently $U \subsetneq B$, since $\dim B_1 = 86$.

The finite certificates and the all-weight implication are presented in Sections 3–6. This is the most directly checkable part of the construction.

Corollary 1.2 (Initial graded pieces)**.** *Under the same finite-certificate hypotheses, U is a simple unitary VOA of CFT type with the ambient conformal vector and central charge eight. Moreover,*

$$U_2 = S_2, \qquad U_3 = S_3, \qquad \mathrm{ch}_U(\tau) = q^{-1/3}(1 + 6q + 120q^2 + 956q^3 + O(q^4)).$$

Here S_2, S_3 are the concrete spaces in Certificate 2.2. This assertion does not require a modular character calculation.

The proof is given after the properness argument. In particular the coefficient 6010 in the proposed character below has a different dependency from the first four coefficients.

We write $\mathcal{H}_3$ for the unitary Haagerup fusion category with six simple objects $\mathbf{1}, \alpha, \alpha^2, \rho, \alpha\rho, \alpha^2\rho$ and fusion rules

$$\alpha^3 = \mathbf{1}, \qquad \alpha\rho = \rho\alpha^{-1}, \qquad \rho^2 = \mathbf{1} + \rho + \alpha\rho + \alpha^2\rho.$$

Here $\mathrm{FPdim}(\rho) = (3 + \sqrt{13})/2$. The other unitary category with this fusion ring, denoted $\mathcal{H}_2$, is Morita equivalent to $\mathcal{H}_3$. Consequently their Drinfeld centers are equivalent even though the fusion categories are not. In the statement below Z denotes this center, not merely its modular matrices.

Theorem 1.3 (Conformal-net realization)**.** *Assume the exact finite construction inputs recorded in Section A and Certificate 7.1. The VOA U is strongly rational and strongly unitary, with central charge eight. Its completely rational smeared-field conformal net $\mathcal{N}_U$ satisfies*

$$\mathrm{Rep}(\mathcal{N}_U) \simeq Z(\mathcal{H}_3)$$

as unitary ribbon categories. The twelve-component character vector is the $\gamma = 0$ Evans–Gannon vector, and in particular

$$\mathrm{ch}_U(\tau) = q^{-1/3}(1 + 6q + 120q^2 + 956q^3 + 6010q^4 + \cdots). \tag{2}$$

There is a diagonal unitary full conformal net with $c_L = c_R = 8$ and partition function $\sum_{i=1}^{12} |\chi_i(\tau)|^2$.

The proof is assembled in Theorem 7.8, Proposition 10.4, Corollary 11.3, and Proposition 12.2. The character argument is given before the analytic comparison and does not presume it.

Theorem 1.4 (Conditional VOA identification)**.** *Under the same construction inputs, assume additionally the geometric annulus comparison in Claim 10.5. Then U is completely unitary and*

$$\mathrm{Rep}(U) \simeq Z(\mathcal{H}_3) \tag{3}$$

as unitary ribbon categories. There is a unitary holomorphic extension $H' \cong V_{E_8}$ whose category of all algebra modules is $\mathcal{H}_3$; its algebra-bimodule category is $\mathcal{H}_3 \boxtimes \mathcal{H}_3^{\mathrm{op}}$.

Here H' is obtained by transporting the canonical $\mathcal{H}_3$ Lagrangian algebra. It need not coincide with the originally embedded extension H/U; the proposed argument identifies that original all-module category only up to the alternatives $\mathcal{H}_2, \mathcal{H}_3$. The full-CFT defects in Theorem 1.4 preserve U, and need not commute with the enlarged E_8 chiral algebra.

1.2 How the qualifications are used

Amber **REVIEW** notes identify the boundary of exact construction inputs and their replay coverage. Red **HIGH PRIORITY REVIEW** notes isolate the unresolved geometric comparison A1 and explain its consequences. A proved lemma is not made into an additional hypothesis merely because its argument is new; its proof and external dependencies are supplied for scrutiny. Conversely, the unproved comparison is explicitly retained as a hypothesis wherever it is used.

Part of the argument	Nature of its evidence
Explicit fields and finite closure	Exact arithmetic over $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{13}, \sqrt{-3})$, saved recipes and full residuals.
Properness in all weights	Recursive algebraic theorem plus finite certificates; no character upper-bound extrapolation.
Rationality and branching	Positive-stress and category arguments, embedded-field and finite-top inputs, and cited external theorems.
Haagerup modular data	Rank exclusions, indicator and character arguments printed below, with exact finite arithmetic checked separately.
Net realization and strong unitarity	Actual branching, linear reconstruction, sector counting, and unitary classification.
Complete VOA unitarity and extension	Conditional on A1, then fusion positivity, unitary classification, and extension theorems.

2 The explicit lattice construction

2.1 Lattice, cocycle, and currents

Use simple lattice vectors indexed $0, \dots, 7$. The Gram matrix has diagonal entries two and off-diagonal entries minus one on

$$(0,1), (1,2), (2,3), (3,4), (2,5), (6,7),$$

with all remaining off-diagonal entries zero. Fix the cocycle

$$\epsilon(a,b) = (-1)^{\sum_i a_i b_i + \sum_{i>j} a_i b_j G_{ij}}. \tag{4}$$

Write $L = E_6 \oplus A_2$ and $\mathfrak{h} = L \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{C}$. The underlying vector space is

$$B = S\big(\mathfrak{h} \otimes t^{-1}\mathbb{C}[t^{-1}]\big) \otimes \mathbb{C}_\epsilon[L].$$

A monomial $h_1(-n_1)\cdots h_r(-n_r)e^\alpha$ has weight $(\alpha,\alpha)/2 + \sum_i n_i$. In particular its weight is a nonnegative integer. The exponent in (4) is bilinear modulo two, and hence defines a normalized two-cocycle. Directly,

$$\frac{\epsilon(\alpha,\beta)}{\epsilon(\beta,\alpha)} = (-1)^{(\alpha,\beta)}, \qquad \epsilon(\alpha,-\alpha) = (-1)^{(\alpha,\alpha)/2}.$$

These identities fix the signs of all root brackets. For example, $e_0^\alpha e^{-\alpha} = -\alpha(-1)\mathbf{1}$ for a root α. The exponential fields obey

$$Y(e^\alpha, z)e^\beta = \epsilon(\alpha,\beta) z^{(\alpha,\beta)} \exp\left(\sum_{n>0} \frac{\alpha(-n)}{n} z^n\right) e^{\alpha+\beta}. \tag{5}$$

Together with the Heisenberg commutation relations, this formula specifies the exact mode engine used by the certificates.

Put $\alpha_i = (0, \dots, 1, \dots, 0)$ and $\alpha_L = (-1, -2, -3, -2, -1, -2, 0, 0)$. With

$$(c_0, \dots, c_7) = (5, 8, 9, 8, 5, 0, 2, 2), \qquad h_R = \sum_i c_i \alpha_i,$$

the two current triples, in the order (H, E, F), are

$$(H_L, E_L, F_L) = (\alpha_L(-1)\mathbf{1}, e^{\alpha_L}, -e^{-\alpha_L}), \tag{6}$$

$$(H_R, E_R, F_R) = \left(h_R(-1)\mathbf{1}, \sum_{c_i \neq 0} e^{\alpha_i}, -\sum_i c_i e^{-\alpha_i} \right). \tag{7}$$

Current letters also denote their zero-mode actions when applied to a state. Thus, for example, $F_R E_R v$ means $(F_R)_0 (E_R)_0 v$.

Lemma 2.1 (The two affine levels)**.** *The triples* (6)–(7) *commute and generate* $A_{1,1} \otimes A_{1,39}$.

Proof. We have $(\alpha_L, \alpha_L) = 2$ and $(\alpha_L, \alpha_i) = 0$ whenever $c_i \neq 0$. Also $(h_R, \alpha_i) = 2$ for every $c_i \neq 0$, and $(h_R, h_R) = 78$. Formula (5) gives $[H_0, E_0] = 2E_0$, $[H_0, F_0] = -2F_0$ and $[E_0, F_0] = H_0$ for both triples. The double poles are

$$(H_L)_1 H_L = 2\mathbf{1}, \quad (E_L)_1 F_L = \mathbf{1}, \quad (H_R)_1 H_R = 78\mathbf{1}, \quad (E_R)_1 F_R = 39\mathbf{1}.$$

Orthogonality gives all mixed singular products equal to zero. These are the affine relations at levels one and thirty-nine. The positive-definite lattice representation is integrable; equivalently one may use the principal $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ embeddings in A_5 and A_2, whose levels 35 and 4 add in the diagonal. Thus the generated factors are the simple positive-integral-level affine VOAs. Their tensor product is simple and embeds in B. □

2.2 The defining field and the positive real form

The exact coefficient convention uses unnormalized simple-root Heisenberg oscillators and a torus gauge in which the principal raising current is the sum of the corresponding simple-root vertices. The lowering current is $-\sum_i c_i e^{-\alpha_i}$, with

$$(c_0, \dots, c_7) = (5, 8, 9, 8, 5, 0, 2, 2).$$

The torus rescales simple-root vertices by $(1/\sqrt{5}, 1/\sqrt{8}, 1/3, 1/\sqrt{8}, 1/\sqrt{5}, 1, 1/\sqrt{2}, 1/\sqrt{2})$. In this convention define

$$\begin{aligned} u = {} & e^{(0,0,0,0,0,-1,1,1)} \\ & + \frac{\sqrt{13} + 3\sqrt{-3}}{20} e^{(0,0,0,1,1,-1,0,0)} \\ & + \frac{\sqrt{13} - 3\sqrt{-3}}{20} e^{(1,1,0,0,0,-1,0,0)}. \end{aligned} \tag{8}$$

The compact real form and PCT operation must be transported through this gauge. Ordinary coefficient conjugation in the displayed gauge is not a replacement for the ambient PCT map.

Here is the transport explicitly. Set $\widetilde{c} = (5, 8, 9, 8, 5, 1, 2, 2)$ and let g be the lattice torus automorphism which fixes the oscillators and multiplies e^{α} by $\prod_i \widetilde{c}_i^{-\alpha_i/2}$. If θ is the ordinary lattice PCT involution, the transported involution is $\theta_g = g\theta g^{-1}$. For real lattice oscillators,

$$\theta_g\big(h_1(-n_1) \cdots h_r(-n_r) e^{\alpha}\big) = (-1)^r \Big(\prod_i \widetilde{c}_i^{\alpha_i}\Big) h_1(-n_1) \cdots h_r(-n_r) e^{-\alpha}. \tag{9}$$

It acts antilinearly on coefficients, so fixes $\sqrt{13}$ and negates $\sqrt{-3}$. The transported Hermitian form is $\langle v, w\rangle_g = \langle g^{-1}v, g^{-1}w\rangle$ and is positive definite. Formula (9) squares to the identity. The same torus element acts on V_{E_8}: the positive real character on L extends by its real linear logarithm to the common Cartan space. We transport the form and PCT on H by that element as well, so the entire inclusion $U \subset B \subset H$ uses one unitary convention. It preserves the current algebra, including the root factor even though its two root vectors have different norms in this gauge.

All three momenta in (8) have squared norm four and Cartan weight $(1, 13)$. Substitution in the lattice formula verifies that u is a highest vector of current type $(2, 14)$, where the entries now denote representation dimensions. In the original positive unitary basis, $g^{-1}u$ is, up to a common scalar,

$$e^a + \zeta e^b + \overline{\zeta} e^c, \qquad \zeta = \frac{\sqrt{13} + 3i\sqrt{3}}{\sqrt{40}}, \qquad |\zeta| = 1,$$

with a, b, c the three displayed momenta. Thus the exact construction fixes a relative phase; there is no remaining continuous parameter.

The ambient and affine conformal vectors are fixed by these conventions:

$$\omega_B = \frac{1}{2}\sum_{i,j}(G^{-1})_{ij}\alpha_i(-1)\alpha_j(-1)\mathbf{1}, \tag{10}$$

$$\omega_{A_{1,k}} = \frac{1}{2(k+2)}\left(\tfrac{1}{2}H_{-1}H + E_{-1}F + F_{-1}E\right). \tag{11}$$

The conformal vector of U is ω_B, not the sum of the two affine conformal vectors. Their central charges sum to $1 + 117/41 < 8$.

2.3 The constructed spaces in weights two and three

Certificate input 2.2 (Actual initial spaces)**.** The saved exact construction gives a PCT-stable 120-dimensional space $S_2 \subset U_2$, containing u, ω_B, the affine vacuum descendants, two neutral primitive fields, and eight charged current multiplets. The current multiplet dimensions are

$$(1, 5), (1, 9), (1, 9), (1, 13), (2, 2), (2, 6), (2, 8), (2, 14).$$

These contribute 96 vectors, in addition to the 22 affine vacuum vectors and two neutral fields. The exact generated grade-three space $S_3 \subset U_3$ has dimension 956. Its normal subspace $N_3 = K_{-1}S_2 + TS_2$ has dimension 634, and

$$S_3 = N_3 + \operatorname{span}\{a_0 b : a, b \in S_2\}, \qquad \dim(S_3/N_3) = 322.$$

The spaces are current-stable. These are dimensions of constructed finite spaces, not initial assertions that they exhaust U_2, U_3.

The source records are `hi_cft_20260923_c8_exact_fields.json`, `hi_cft_20260923_c8_exact_unitary_certificate.json`, and `hi_cft_20260923_c8_minimal_generators.json`, together with the exact grade-three checkpoint bound into the final ledger.

The minimal-generator record is logically prior to the closure records. It starts with the six specified currents, ω_B, and u, then closes their weight-two span under current zero modes and u_1. Every intermediate vector is therefore an actual U-vector. The final span has dimension 120 and contains each independently specified highest vector and neutral conformal vector. The equality with the saved space S_2 is checked only after this construction. This is the step

that relates the large certificate presentation to the short definition (1); an ambient weight-two dimension count alone would not do so.

For reference the two neutral fields, denoted e, f, satisfy

$$e + f = \omega_B - \omega_{A_{1,1}} - \omega_{A_{1,39}}, \qquad c_e = \frac{2400}{1271}, \quad c_f = \frac{70}{31}. \tag{12}$$

They commute as Virasoro fields. The exact current and stress eigenvalues on the eight primitive highest vectors are as follows. The two occurrences of $(1, 9)$ are distinct vectors.

Current dimensions (n, m)	e_1 eigenvalue	f_1 eigenvalue
$(1, 5)$	798/1271	38/31
$(1, 9)$	200/1271	42/31
$(1, 9)$	1512/1271	10/31
$(1, 13)$	420/1271	20/31
$(2, 2)$	192/1271	49/31
$(2, 6)$	1830/1271	3/31
$(2, 8)$	752/1271	24/31
$(2, 14)$	180/1271	13/31

Each row obeys

$$\frac{n^2 - 1}{12} + \frac{m^2 - 1}{164} + h_e + h_f = 2.$$

The affine vacuum space contributes 22 dimensions in weight two: 4 from $A_{1,1}$, 9 from $A_{1,39}$, and $3 \cdot 3$ mixed current products. The level-one null multiplet removes five of the nine universal weight-two states of its affine factor. Together with the two singlets and the 96 charged states, this gives 120. The exact normal-space and rank calculations certify these spaces inside the lattice algebra, including their intersections.

3 Finite closure and the all-weight criterion

Write $Y(a, z) = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{Z}} a_n z^{-n-1}$ and $T = L(-1)$. A singular product has mode index $n \geq 0$. The zero mode a_0 is a derivation and commutes with T.

Definition 3.1 (Differential normal span)**.** For a homogeneous positive-weight subspace $S \subset V$, let $\mathcal{N}(S)$ be the linear span of the vacuum and every expression obtained from vectors of S by translation and arbitrary parenthesized (-1) products. Let $\mathcal{N}_d(S) = \mathcal{N}(S) \cap V_d$. This definition makes translation and normal multiplication closed operations on $\mathcal{N}(S)$; closure under singular products is a separate assertion. We use the usual convention that a set strongly generates when its differential normal span is the whole algebra.

Lemma 3.2 (Filtered Wick reduction)**.** *Let V be a nonnegatively integer-graded vertex algebra with $V_0 = \mathbb{C}\mathbf{1}$, and let S have strictly positive weights. Fix w. Suppose every singular product of two homogeneous generators of total weight less than w belongs to $\mathcal{N}(S)$. Then the same is true for two normal expressions of total weight less than w. It is also true at total weight w if at least one expression is a derivative of a positive-weight expression or a normal product of two positive-weight expressions.*

Proof. Use induction on total input weight. A vacuum factor has zero singular bracket. Sesquilinearity removes a derivative and lowers the total input weight; the resulting powers of the formal variable and translations preserve coefficientwise membership in $\mathcal{N}(S)$. Skew

symmetry allows a composite input to be placed on the right. The noncommutative Wick identity is

$$[x_\lambda : yz :] =: [x_\lambda y]z : + : y[x_\lambda z] : + \int_0^\lambda [[x_\lambda y]_\mu z]\, d\mu. \tag{13}$$

The first two brackets have smaller total input weight, since an omitted factor has positive weight. Their coefficients therefore admit homogeneous expressions in $\mathcal{N}(S)$. A coefficient $x_j y$ in the integral has weight $\mathrm{wt}(x) + \mathrm{wt}(y) - j - 1$. Its pairing with z has total weight at most $\mathrm{wt}(x) + \mathrm{wt}(y) + \mathrm{wt}(z) - 1$, so induction applies again. If the coefficient is scalar, its bracket is zero. Normal multiplication preserves the first two terms by definition. This proves both assertions, including the case in which both inputs are composite. Neither a preferred parenthesization nor independence of normal words was used. □

Theorem 3.3 (Recursive strong-generation criterion)**.** *Let V be a nonnegatively graded vertex algebra with $V_0 = \mathbb{C}\mathbf{1}$. Choose finite homogeneous subspaces $S_d \subset V_d$, $1 \le d \le h$, where $h \ge 2$, and let $\mathcal{N}$ be their differential normally ordered span, allowing every parenthesization. Put $K = S_1$ and $A = S_2$. Assume*

1. *$k_n s, a_n s \in \mathcal{N}$ for every $k \in K$, $a \in A$, $s \in S_d$, and $n \ge 0$;*
2. *for $d \ge 3$,*
$$S_d \subset A_0 S_{d-1} + \mathcal{N}_d(S_1 + \cdots + S_{d-1}).$$

Then $\mathcal{N}$ is a vertex subalgebra. In particular, the chosen spaces strongly generate the vertex algebra that they generate.

Proof. The first assumption, the derivation property and $[T, a_0] = 0$ give $a_0\mathcal{N} \subset \mathcal{N}$ for $a \in A$. Explicitly, $a_0(x_{-1}y) = (a_0x)_{-1}y + x_{-1}(a_0y)$, so induction on the construction of a normal expression proves this stability before any singular-product closure is known.

Now induct lexicographically on $(\mathrm{wt}(s) + \mathrm{wt}(t), \mathrm{wt}(s))$ for generator pairs s, t. Left weight one or two is the first assumption. Otherwise the second assumption reduces the left input to $s = a_0 b$, with $\mathrm{wt}(b) = \mathrm{wt}(s) - 1$, plus normal remainders. The latter are covered by Lemma 3.2: a homogeneous remainder of weight $\mathrm{wt}(s)$ in lower-weight generators has no single undifferentiated generator of that weight. Use

$$(a_0 b)_n t = a_0(b_n t) - b_n(a_0 t). \tag{14}$$

The first term has smaller total pair weight before applying a_0, which preserves $\mathcal{N}$. The known normal expression for $a_0 t$ has weight $\mathrm{wt}(t) + 1$. Every derivative or composite term reduces total pair weight in the second term. The only remaining possibility is a single undifferentiated generator of weight $\mathrm{wt}(t) + 1$; its pairing with b has the original total weight and smaller left weight. It is therefore an earlier induction case. If $\mathrm{wt}(t) = h$, this single-generator possibility is absent.

All generator singular products close. Wick induction then gives closure for all normal expressions. Translation and normal multiplication preserve $\mathcal{N}$ by definition. For $r \ge 1$,

$$x_{-r}y = \frac{1}{(r-1)!}(T^{r-1}x)_{-1}y,$$

so all negative modes close too. □

For the Wick identities see [1, Section 2]. The full local derivation is `hi_cft_20260923_next_structure_recursive_strong_certificate.md`.

Remark 3.4 (Finite scope of the input)**.** Every membership in the first hypothesis has output weight at most $h+1$. Thus the criterion avoids checking all generator pairs through weight $2h-1$. The second hypothesis is essential: it asserts actual zero-product identities, rather than agreement of a dimension or a character coefficient. The proof takes place in the given ambient vertex algebra and makes no assertion that its normal words are free. This resolves the all-weight implication formerly marked F2.

3.1 The finite spaces and prerequisite controls

Choose actual quotient lifts $P_3 \subset S_3$ and an actual triplet $P_4 \subset U_4$, with joint current highest weight $(0,2)$, and set

$$N_4 = K_{-1}S_3 + TS_3 + (S_2)_{-1}S_2, \qquad W_4 = N_4 + P_4, \tag{15}$$

$$N_5 = K_{-1}W_4 + TW_4 + (S_2)_{-1}S_3. \tag{16}$$

These denote full differential normal spaces, using the lower closure identities to reorder expressions. A computational solver may use a proper subset of actual words in these spaces.

The triplet is obtained from an actual $a_0 p$ by current-zero-mode projectors and lowering. It satisfies $P_4 \subset (S_2)_0 S_3 + N_4$.

Lemma 3.5 (Bounds for the current projectors)**.** *On ambient weight d, a Cartan element represented by $h \in L \otimes \mathbb{R}$ has eigenvalues m satisfying $m^2 \le 2d(h,h)$. At weight four the two current highest weights are therefore at most* 4 *and* 24*.*

Proof. Cartan zero modes act on a Fock monomial of momentum α by (h,α), and commute with its oscillators. The grading gives $(\alpha,\alpha) \le 2d$, so the estimate is Cauchy–Schwarz in the positive lattice form. Every eigenvalue is integral. Apply the estimate to $(h,h) = 2, 78$ and $d = 4$, and then to the highest vectors in the finite-dimensional semisimple current decomposition. □

Consequently finite polynomials in FE give exact projectors. For an input of weight $(0,2)$, one may use

$$\prod_{\ell=1}^{2}\left(1 - \frac{F_L E_L}{\ell(\ell+1)}\right), \qquad \prod_{\ell=2}^{12}\left(1 - \frac{F_R E_R}{\ell(\ell+1)-2}\right).$$

The raising operator acts first in every FE factor. Indeed, on the weight-m line in an $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ representation of highest weight j, FE acts by $(j-m)(j+m+2)/4$. The first polynomial retains left highest weight zero. At right weight two the second retains highest weight two and kills every possible larger highest weight. Thus all denominators are nonzero and the projector has a finite, justified range.

Certificate input 3.6 (Lower identities and the actual triplet)**.** The lower-closure artifact contains 3,970 completed exact identities. The actual P_4 vectors satisfy 18 current-zero-mode identities and six independently checked inclusions

$$L(1)P_4 \subset S_3, \qquad L(2)P_4 \subset S_2.$$

These direct Virasoro checks are available before the weight-four gate.

The two gates left for the all-weight argument are

$$(S_2)_0 S_3 \subset W_4 \qquad \text{(Gate 4)}, \tag{17}$$

$$(S_2)_0 P_4 \subset N_5 \qquad \text{(Gate 5)}. \tag{18}$$

4 Gate 4: exact seeds, raising, and singlet recovery

Put $P = S_3/N_3$, of independently known dimension 322. For a fixed joint-highest primitive field $a \in S_2$, the map

$$f_a : P \longrightarrow B_4/W_4, \qquad [p] \longmapsto [a_0 p]$$

is well defined because the lower relations give $a_0 N_3 \subset N_4$. Current covariance implies that its kernel is stable under both commuting raising operators E_L, E_R.

Lemma 4.1 (Raising saturation)**.** *If $C_a \subset \ker f_a$ and $P = E_L P + E_R P + C_a$, then $f_a = 0$.*

Proof. On $M = P/\ker f_a$ the hypothesis says $M = E_L M + E_R M$. The commuting ideal (E_L, E_R) acts nilpotently because all current weights are bounded. Iterating gives $M = (E_L, E_R)^r M = 0$ for sufficiently large r. □

In this application nilpotence is entirely finite-dimensional. At weight three Lemma 3.5 bounds the two Cartan eigenvalues by $|m_L| \le 3$ and $|m_R| \le 21$. Either raising operator increases $m_L + m_R$ by two. Every word of length 25 in the two raising operators therefore vanishes on P. The quotient by $\ker f_a$ inherits these operators because the kernel is stable. This gives an explicit termination bound for the argument; there is no limiting step.

The exact raising coordinates comprise 644 images. Their rank is 294. For each of nine independent highest left fields, the completed seed sets and these images have rank 322. A nonzero minor at the good split prime $p = 1{,}000{,}003$ proves a nonzero characteristic-zero minor. This proves spanning because the exact ambient quotient dimension is already 322. It does not give an upper rank for an unknown weight-four normal space.

The original exact run supplies 2,145 seed identities. The saturation calculation asks for 130 further inputs; 118 have direct exact residual certificates. The remaining twelve outputs have weight $(0, 0)$. An exact replay of the known kernel and twelve additional identities at output weight $(0, 2)$ shows that both raising currents kill each of these twelve remaining classes modulo W_4.

Lemma 4.2 (Recovery from a joint-singlet projection)**.** *Let $t \in B_4$ have weight $(0, 0)$, with $E_L t, E_R t \in W_4$. Define*

$$\Pi = \prod_{j \in \{2,4\}} \left(1 - \frac{4F_L E_L}{j(j+2)}\right) \prod_{j \in \{2,4,\ldots,24\}} \left(1 - \frac{4F_R E_R}{j(j+2)}\right). \tag{19}$$

If Πt is a linear combination of Πn_i, with $n_i \in N_4$, then $t \in W_4$.

Proof. Both W_4 and N_4 are stable under current zero modes. Every FE factor kills $[t] \in B_4/W_4$, so $[\Pi t] = [t]$. Each Πn_i remains in $N_4 \subset W_4$. Thus $[t] = 0$. Equivalently, the weight-zero highest class is a singlet in the finite semisimple current module. No dimension assertion about the selected normal columns is needed. □

The prime search selects 21 independent projected normal columns. All twelve projected identities have complete residual zero over $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{13}, \sqrt{-3})$. The final verifier repeats those residuals by independent integer denominator clearing, authenticates the raising premise, and repeats all nine saturation ranks. By Lemmas 4.1 and 4.2, all $9 \cdot 322 = 2898$ required highest-left identities hold. Current covariance gives the charged descendants. The second neutral field follows from $\omega_B - \omega_{K_L} - \omega_{K_R}$ minus the retained neutral field. This proves (17) with the certified lower controls.

4.1 Positive modes available after Gate 4

The normal-product argument at the next gate uses positive modes on S_3. We establish them here, before their first use. This also explains why no additional unverified positive-mode gate is required.

Lemma 4.3 (Virasoro and current bootstrap)**.** *The lower identities, the direct P_4 controls, and Gate 4 imply*

$$(S_2)_1S_3 \subset S_3, \qquad (S_2)_2S_3 \subset S_2, \qquad (S_2)_3S_3 \subset K, \tag{20}$$
$$K_1W_4 \subset S_3, \qquad K_2W_4 \subset S_2, \qquad K_3W_4 \subset K, \tag{21}$$
$$L(1)N_5 \subset W_4, \qquad L(2)N_5 \subset S_3. \tag{22}$$

The next mode in each of the first two lines is scalar, and all further modes vanish.

Proof. The exact lower inputs give all singular products of K and S_2 with S_2 in the expected lower spaces. The provenance $S_3 = N_3 + (S_2)_0S_2$ and the current commutator give

$$K_0S_3 \subset S_3, \qquad K_1S_3 \subset S_2, \qquad K_2S_3 \subset K.$$

For instance,

$$k_1(a_0b) = (k_0a)_1b + (k_1a)_0b + a_0(k_1b). \tag{23}$$

The Virasoro commutators for a weight-two vector are

$$[L(1), a_n] = (2-n)a_{n+1} + (L(1)a)_n, \tag{24}$$
$$[L(2), a_n] = (3-n)a_{n+2} + 3(L(1)a)_{n+1} + (L(2)a)_n. \tag{25}$$

They show $L(1)S_3 \subset S_2$ and $L(2)S_3 \subset K$. Applied to the three summands of N_4, they give $L(1)N_4 \subset S_3$ and $L(2)N_4 \subset S_2$. For a normal input $a_{-1}b$ the latter formula includes the scalar term $(L(2)a)_{-1}b$; it must not be omitted. It lies in S_2. The six direct controls of Certificate 3.6 extend these inclusions to W_4 without using Gate 5.

Each of the eight charged primitive multiplets and the two neutral singlets in S_2 is quasiprimary. Indeed, $L(1)$ is equivariant for current zero modes, and none of their current types is $(3,1)$ or $(1,3)$, the two types in K. For such a vector a and $p \in S_3$, Gate 4 and the preceding controls give

$$\begin{aligned} 2a_1p &= L(1)(a_0p) - a_0L(1)p \in S_3, \\ a_2p &= L(1)(a_1p) - a_1L(1)p \in S_2, \\ 2a_3p &= L(2)(a_1p) - a_1L(2)p \in K. \end{aligned}$$

In the last line the possible $(L(2)a)_1$ term is zero since $L(2)a$ is scalar. The affine normal and derivative part of S_2 is handled by the current iterate identities. This proves (20) on all of S_2.

The actual construction gives $P_4 \subset (S_2)_0S_3 + N_4$. Equation (23), now with $b \in S_3$, gives $K_1P_4 \subset S_3$; the same inclusion for N_4 follows on its normal generators. Since currents are primary of weight one,

$$[L(1), k_1] = -k_2, \qquad [L(2), k_1] = -k_3.$$

The controls on $L(1)W_4, L(2)W_4$ consequently give (21). The remaining modes follow from grading.

Finally apply $L(1), L(2)$ to $N_5 = K_{-1}W_4 + TW_4 + (S_2)_{-1}S_3$. The current and translation summands follow from the established inclusions and the Virasoro relations. For the third summand, the required formulas are

$$L(1)(a_{-1}p) = 3a_0p + (L(1)a)_{-1}p + a_{-1}L(1)p,$$
$$L(2)(a_{-1}p) = 4a_1p + 3(L(1)a)_0p + (L(2)a)_{-1}p + a_{-1}L(2)p.$$

Every term belongs respectively to W_4 or S_3 by Gate 4, (20), and the lower identities. Reordering the last normal term uses only already established lower products. This proves (22). □

5 Gate 5 from Jacobi identities

The proof uses the full normal spaces in (15)–(16), not only the selected solver columns. To see that the displayed formula for N_5 includes every lower normal word of weight five, remove a leading derivative, or split a normal product into weights $1+4$ or $2+3$. Reversed splits are reordered by skew symmetry for normal products. Its correction terms are derivatives of singular products, already controlled by Lemma 4.3 and the lower identities. Quasi-associativity changes the parenthesization with correction terms of the same type. Thus the resulting words lie in $K_{-1}W_4 + TW_4 + (S_2)_{-1}S_3$.

Lemma 5.1 (Normal-space controls)**.** *Before using Gate 5, the lower controls and Gate 4 give*

$$(S_2)_0N_4 \subset N_5, \qquad (N_3)_0S_3 \subset N_5. \tag{26}$$

Proof. The first follows by zero-mode derivation and skew reordering. For the second, $(Ta)_0 = 0$ and, for a current x,

$$(x_{-1}a)_0p = \sum_{i\geq 0} x_{-1-i}(a_ip) + \sum_{i\geq 0} a_{-1-i}(x_ip). \tag{27}$$

All inner products belong to the required lower spaces. To make the translation reduction explicit, repeatedly use

$$x_{-r}v = \frac{T(x_{-(r-1)}v) - x_{-(r-1)}Tv}{r-1}, \qquad r \geq 2.$$

The base terms are precisely those in (16); the same identity applies to $a_{-r}v$ with $a \in S_2$. Thus no unproved P_3-by-P_3 closure enters (26). All positive inner modes in (27) are supplied by (20) and the current controls established before this section. More explicitly the first sum has inner vectors in $W_4, S_3, S_2, K, \mathbb{C}\mathbf{1}$, in that order; the second has inner vectors in $S_3, S_2, K, \mathbb{C}\mathbf{1}$. Both sums are finite by grading. □

If $P_4 \subset N_4$, Gate 5 already follows. Otherwise $Q = W_4/N_4$ is the irreducible current triplet of highest weight $(0, 2)$, since the actual P_4 is irreducible. Let q_-, q_0, q_+ be its weight basis, and set

$$\beta(a, p) = [a_0p] \in Q, \qquad F(a, q) = [a_0\tilde{q}] \in B_5/N_5.$$

The second map does not depend on the representative $\tilde{q} \in W_4$, by (26).

Lemma 5.2 (Jacobi reduction)**.** *If $a, b \in S_2$ satisfy $a_0b \in N_3$, then for $p \in S_3$,*

$$F(a, \beta(b, p)) = F(b, \beta(a, p)). \tag{28}$$

Proof. The difference is the class of $(a_0b)_0p$, which vanishes by (26) and $[a_0, b_0] = (a_0b)_0$. □

5.1 The charged families

Let $a_0, \dots, a_7$ denote the eight charged highest fields, with current weights

$$(0,4),(0,8),(0,8),(0,12),(1,1),(1,5),(1,7),(1,13).$$

In a product such as $(a_i)_0 p$, the parenthesized subscript denotes the field label and the next subscript denotes its mode. The saved exact relations give

$$\beta(a_3,p_3) = c_3 q_-, \qquad \beta(a_6,p_6) = c_6 q_-, \qquad c_3 c_6 \neq 0,$$

where $p_3 =$ `r3_000910` has weight $(0,-14)$, and $p_6 =$ `r3_000899` has weight $(-1,-9)$. The coefficients are authenticated in the final Jacobi certificate. Exact combinations of the lower relations establish $(a_i)_0 a_j \in N_3$ for the following pairs:

i	j	Input	Weight of $(a_i)_0 p_j$
0	3	p_3	$(0,-10)$
1,2	3	p_3	$(0,-6)$
3	6	p_6	$(-1,3)$
4	6	p_6	$(0,-8)$
5	3	p_3	$(1,-9)$
6	3	p_3	$(1,-7)$
7	3	p_3	$(1,-1)$

Every listed output weight lies outside Q, so $\beta(a_i,p_j) = 0$. Equation (28) and $c_j \neq 0$ give $F(a_i,q_-) = 0$. Raise this resulting zero with a_i held highest to obtain the other two right inputs. Current covariance gives all left descendants.

Remark 5.3. The weight exclusion is used only at the displayed bottom inputs. It need not hold after raising p_j; using it there would be an incorrect stronger assertion. We raise the proved zero identity instead.

5.2 The neutral family

Let C be the full current span, inside $P = S_3/N_3$, of brackets of charged weight-two fields. The charged-span certificate reconstructs 28 actual charged seeds from the exact lower relations. Together with the 644 lowering images, of rank 294, these have rank 322. The independent verifier also checks both $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ commutators and all cross-axis commutators against the saved exact raising matrices. Since C is a current submodule, the nilpotent-ideal argument gives

$$P = F_L P + F_R P + C \quad \Longrightarrow \quad P/C = 0.$$

Once again the finite-prime full rank is a positive spanning witness inside an independently exact 322-dimensional space.

For the retained neutral singlet e, write

$$e_0 a_3 = \sum_i t_i (x_i)_0 y_i + n, \qquad n \in N_3,$$

with charged x_i, y_i. Apply zero modes to p_3. By Jacobi, the charged conclusion and (26),

$$(e_0 a_3)_0 p_3 = \sum_i t_i [(x_i)_0, (y_i)_0] p_3 + n_0 p_3 \in N_5.$$

Indeed Gate 4 puts each inner product in W_4, and the next charged product is controlled on both N_4 and P_4. A second Jacobi identity gives

$$e_0((a_3)_0p_3) = (a_3)_0(e_0p_3) + (e_0a_3)_0p_3 \in N_5.$$

The nonzero coefficient of q_- proves the neutral bottom identity; covariance gives the triplet. The other neutral field is obtained from the total stress minus the two affine Sugawara stresses and e. This proves Gate 5. Its 24 independent highest channels comprise 23 charged channels and one neutral channel; they are consequences of the displayed identities, not 24 separately recomputed grade-five lattice products.

6 From the finite gates to properness

Lemma 4.3 supplies the positive-current products and $L(1)N_5 \subset W_4$, $L(2)N_5 \subset S_3$ before Gate 5. For a quasiprimary primitive $a \in S_2$, Gate 5 now yields, for $p \in P_4$,

$$\begin{aligned} 2a_1p &= L(1)(a_0p) - a_0L(1)p \in W_4, \\ a_2p &= L(1)(a_1p) - a_1L(1)p \in S_3, \\ 2a_3p &= L(2)(a_1p) - a_1L(2)p \in S_2, \\ a_4p &= L(2)(a_2p) - a_2L(2)p \in K. \end{aligned}$$

The next mode is scalar. The 30 earlier prime-only a_1P_4 tests are therefore derived exactly here; they are not an omitted gate.

All hypotheses of Theorem 3.3 hold for K, S_2, S_3, P_4. Their normal span is a vertex subalgebra of U containing K, u, ω_B, hence equals U. A normal word in positive-weight generators cannot acquire weight one unless it is a weight-one generator. Thus $U_1 = K$, proving Proposition 1.1.

Proof of Corollary 1.2. A differential normal word of weight two uses only K and S_2; its current descendants are already in S_2. A word of weight three uses only K, S_2, S_3, and the lower normal words lie in N_3. Thus the strong-generation result proves $U_2 = S_2$ and $U_3 = S_3$. The exact PCT certificate gives $\theta_g S_2 = S_2$, while $\theta_g K = K$. Since $S_2 \subset U$ contains the original generators, $\theta_g U = U$. The inherited positive form makes U a unitary subalgebra of B, hence simple by [3, Proposition 5.29]. It contains ω_B, so has central charge eight, the same nonnegative grading, and $U_0 = \mathbb{C}\mathbf{1}$. The character assertion is now the definition of the graded trace. □

REVIEW — F1: what the finite certificate establishes

This proof of properness has the strongest computational support in the manuscript. It still relies on correctness of the lattice mode engine, the saved actual-vector recipes, and the stated algebraic lemmas. Hashes authenticate the records; hashes alone do not prove those lemmas or independently reconstruct every earlier mode calculation. The Lean checks in Appendix B cover selected abstract implications, not the VOA construction or the complete strong-generation argument. No second implementation of the entire construction is claimed. In particular, $\dim U_4 = 6010$ is not used as an input to this proof.

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7 Regularity from a positive conformal-vector identity

This section concerns the actual PCT-stable subalgebra $U \subset B$ defined in the construction. Its conclusions do not require properness. We use the convention $Y(a,z) = \sum_{n\in\mathbb{Z}} a_n z^{-n-1}$ and

write $L^e(n) = e_{n+1}$ for the Virasoro operators of a conformal vector e. The subalgebras used below need not contain the ambient conformal vector. We call an inclusion $A \subset V$ *grading compatible* if the A-weight of each homogeneous vector of A equals its V-weight. Thus a mode a_n changes both gradings by $\mathrm{wt}(a) - n - 1$; the equality of the two energy operators is not required on all of V. All subalgebras in the positive identity below are grading compatible and stable under the ambient PCT involution.

Certificate input 7.1 (Embedded structural data)**.** The following are assertions about actual fields and their exact modes in the lattice construction, in addition to the finite closure ledger.

1. The Potts fields lie in U, are PCT stable, and generate the regular unitary algebra $K(\mathfrak{sl}_2, 3)$, with its translation and intrinsic grading inherited from the ambient VOA. The exact records are `hi_cft_20260923_proof_potts.json` and `hi_cft_20260923_proof_potts_exact.json`.

2. The actual fields z, a of weights two and three lie in U, are PCT stable, have central charge $8/5$, and satisfy the stress, primary, and translation identities in `hi_cft_20260923_proof_pf13_exact.json`, `hi_cft_20260923_proof_pf13_membership.json`, and `hi_cft_20260923_proof_remaining_coset.json`. Their full singular first rows agree with the parafermion rows at $c = 8/5$, $\lambda = 14/473$, as polynomials in $z, a, a_1a, a_1(a_1a)$. The polynomial records are `hi_cft_20260923_proof_pf13_upper_poles.json`, `hi_cft_20260923_proof_pf13_nonlinear.json`, `hi_cft_20260923_proof_pf13_truncation.json`, `hi_cft_20260923_proof_pf13_simple_pole_algebra.json`, and `hi_cft_20260923_proof_pf13_dly.json`. The membership record also gives the positive identity (29).

3. The lattice–Potts core T below is embedded with its stated charge realization. The six joint spectral vectors used to construct its order-thirteen extension are actual vectors of U_2, with the eigenvalues printed below. Their exact source is `hi_cft_20260923_next_structure_core_extension.json`; the construction of T is described in `hi_cft_20260923_proof_report.md`, Section 4.

4. The zero-mode action on the complementary eighty currents is irreducible, and the four mixed lattice tops of dimension eighty-one are irreducible as U-tops. These are exact field-action assertions, as recorded in `hi_cft_20260923_proof_current_module_v2.json` and `hi_cft_20260923_next_81top_all.json`, respectively.

All polynomial equalities here mean exact vector equalities in the fixed lattice realization, not projected or floating-point matches.

The input from the local construction is the identity

$$\omega_U = \omega_{A_{1,1}} + \frac{3403}{4563}\omega_{A_{1,39}} + \frac{25}{6}\overline{p} + \frac{25}{26}\overline{z}. \tag{29}$$

Here p and z are the conformal vectors of actual embedded copies of the three-state Potts algebra $K(\mathfrak{sl}_2, 3)$ and the parafermion algebra $K(\mathfrak{sl}_2, 13)$; a bar denotes normalized averaging over the compact current group. Each subalgebra is regular and unitary, and its intrinsic grading agrees with the ambient grading on its states. The averages take place in the finite-dimensional space U_2. More concretely, p, z lie in the already constructed current-stable space S_2, whose invariant subspace is spanned by the four mutually orthogonal stresses $\omega_{A_{1,1}}, \omega_{A_{1,39}}, e, f$. For either vector v, its Haar average is therefore

$$\overline{v} = \sum_{w \in \{\omega_{A_{1,1}}, \omega_{A_{1,39}}, e, f\}} \frac{\langle v, w\rangle_g}{\langle w, w\rangle_g}\, w.$$

Thus the exact coefficients in (29) can be verified inside S_2 without assuming $S_2 = U_2$ or properness. The compact orbit of a conformal vector has compact convex hull in the real space of PCT-fixed weight-two vectors. Its Haar average belongs to that hull. Carathéodory's theorem therefore replaces each average by a finite convex combination of orbit points. In particular,

$$\omega_U = \sum_{i=1}^{N} c_i e_i, \qquad c_i > 0. \tag{30}$$

Zero coefficients, if any, are omitted. All simple modules of each regular subalgebra A_i have nonnegative lowest weights, with zero occurring only for its vacuum module.

REVIEW — R1: the embedded regular factors are local inputs

Certificate 7.1 states the model-specific field inputs explicitly. Proposition 7.2 below proves the transport from the complete checked parafermion rows to the actual factor identification. It does not replace verification of the listed lattice identities, Potts embedding, or positive stress identity. These inputs are separate from the finite closure theorem.

Proposition 7.2 (Finite reconstruction of the parafermion factor)**.** *Let V, V' be simple vertex algebras of CFT type generated by a conformal vector L and a weight-three primary a. Set $b = a_1 a$ and $d = a_1 b$, of weights four and five. Suppose the full singular products $a_n a, a_n b, a_n d$, $n \geq 0$, agree as homogeneous differential normal polynomials in L, a, b, d, with the same normal ordering. Suppose also that their self-row is*

$$a_5 a = \frac{c}{3}\mathbf{1}, \quad a_4 a = 0, \quad a_3 a = 2L, \quad a_2 a = TL, \quad a_1 a = b, \quad a_0 a = \frac{1}{2}Tb - \frac{1}{12}T^3 L,$$

and that $a_n b = 0$ for $n \geq 4$, $a_3 b \in \mathbb{C}a$, and $a_2 b \in \mathbb{C}Ta$. Then there is an isomorphism $V \cong V'$ identifying L, a, b, d. In particular $a_1 d$ and both simple poles must be specified polynomials; they cannot be left as independent new generators.

Proof. We first recover the remaining generator OPEs without a circular normal-product reduction. The Virasoro rows follow by commuting Virasoro modes through $b = a_1 a$ and $d = a_1 b$:

$$L(m)b = (2m+1)a_{m+1}a, \qquad L(m)d = (2m+1)a_{m+1}b + a_1 L(m)b \quad (m \geq 1).$$

These are linear in generators and derivatives under the displayed hypotheses. Thus Virasoro creation operators can be moved to the outside of any normal word using already known commutators. Sesquilinearity removes derivatives. Since three non-Virasoro factors have weight at least nine, the possible two-factor cores through weight eight are exactly

weight bound	cores besides individual fields
6	$:aa:$
7	$:aa:,\ :ab:$
8	$:aa:,\ :ab:,\ :bb:,\ :ad:$.

Reversing the order of a core uses skew symmetry and its already known pair bracket. Commuting an external a_n or b_n through outer Virasoro creation operators reduces their number; any resulting negative mode is itself a normal product.

Write A_r for the evaluation of $a_n P$, $n \geq 0$, on every normal polynomial P of weight at most r, and B_r for the corresponding assertion with b_n. We use the noncommutative Wick

identity [1, Section 2]

$$[x_\lambda : yz :] =: [x_\lambda y]z : + : y[x_\lambda z] : + \int_0^\lambda [[x_\lambda y]_\mu z]\, d\mu.$$

The following order is acyclic. First A_6 is known: the only two-factor core is $: aa :$, and $[a_\lambda a]$ is linear in the vacuum and derivatives of L, b, whose brackets with a are given. The iterate identity

$$b_n s = a_1(a_n s) - a_0(a_{n+1}s) + a_{n+1}(a_0 s) - a_n(a_1 s) \tag{31}$$

with $s = b$ now determines $b_n b$, because each inner $a_j b$ has weight at most six. Next A_7 follows: its new core $: ab :$ uses only the just-computed b, b row in the Wick integral. Equation (31) with $s = d$ then determines $b_n d$, since every inner $a_j d$ has weight at most seven.

At this point B_6 is known. For its core $: aa :$ the Wick integral brackets a coefficient of $[b_\lambda a]$, of weight at most six, with a, which is A_6 after skew symmetry. Single-field inputs use the known b, b and b, d rows. We obtain A_8 next: its core $: bb :$ uses B_6 on coefficients of $[a_\lambda b]$, and its core $: ad :$ uses the known L, d and b, d rows. Finally B_7 follows from B_6 on the coefficients of $[b_\lambda a]$ in the new core $: ab :$. With $s = d$, the second iterate identity

$$d_n s = a_1(b_n s) - a_0(b_{n+1}s) + b_{n+1}(a_0 s) - b_n(a_1 s)$$

computes $d_n d$: the first two terms use A_8, and the last two use B_7. All generator singular products have therefore been expressed by the same polynomials in the two algebras.

For the uniqueness step, take the vertex subalgebra $D \subset V \times V'$ generated by the diagonal pairs of the four named fields. Common polynomial OPE closure and filtered Wick induction show that D is their differential normal span. Every generator has positive weight, so $D_0 = \mathbb{C}(\mathbf{1}, \mathbf{1})$ and $D_n = 0$ for $n < 0$. It follows that D has a unique maximal proper graded ideal: every proper graded ideal has zero degree-zero part, and so does their sum. The coordinate projections are surjective because L, a generate each target. They preserve the conformal vector and hence the grading. Their kernels are maximal proper graded ideals because V, V' are simple. The kernels coincide, which gives the asserted isomorphism. No freeness or independence of normal monomials has been used. □

The exact parafermion records instantiate this proposition at $c = 8/5$ and $\lambda = 14/473$. The upper-pole record supplies the self-row and the remaining positive poles, the nonlinear record supplies $a_0 b$, and the truncation record supplies $a_1 d$. The algebraic simple-pole derivation supplies $a_0 d$ from the independently checked upper poles and skew symmetry. The Dong–Lam–Yamada change-of-generators record matches the seven weight-six decoupling coefficients with those of $K(\mathfrak{sl}_2, 13)$, using [41, Appendix B]. The common first rows are the recursive formulas (5.4), (5.7), and (A.2) of Linshaw [40]. Simplicity of the actual generated subalgebra follows from its PCT stability; its translation operator agrees with the ambient one by the complementary positive energy argument. Thus the proposition transports the checked polynomial identities to an identification with the parafermion algebra. The exact membership, PCT, translation, and polynomial identities remain the explicit finite inputs to this identification.

Lemma 7.3 (Orthogonal energy bound)**.** *Let V be a unitary VOA of CFT type admitting an identity of the form (30), with the properties just stated. Then V is C_2-cofinite.*

Proof. For an ordinary simple A_i-module M, put

$$C_{2,A_i}(M) = \operatorname{span}\{a_{-2}m : a \in A_i,\ m \in M\}.$$

These quotients are finite-dimensional by [6, Proposition 5.2]. They are graded for the intrinsic operator $L^{e_i}(0)$. There are finitely many simple A_i-modules. Hence there is a finite number

D_i bounding the intrinsic energy in all their C_{2,A_i} quotients; this includes their lowest weights. Regularity decomposes the weak A_i-module V into ordinary simples. Consequently every intrinsic eigenvector of energy above D_i lies in $C_{2,A_i}(V)$. The intrinsic energy preserves each finite-dimensional ambient grade V_n and is self-adjoint for its positive form. We may therefore diagonalize it on V_n. Since

$$C_{2,A_i}(V) \subset C_2(V),$$

every vector in $V_n \cap C_2(V)^\perp$ has zero projection to the intrinsic eigenvectors of energy above D_i. It follows that

$$\langle L^{e_i}(0)v, v\rangle \le D_i\|v\|^2 \qquad (v \in V_n \cap C_2(V)^\perp).$$

For $v \in V_n \cap C_2(V)^\perp$, the conformal-vector identity gives

$$n\|v\|^2 = \sum_i c_i\langle L^{e_i}(0)v, v\rangle \le \Big(\sum_i c_i D_i\Big)\|v\|^2.$$

The subspace $C_2(V)$ is ambient graded. Its orthogonal complement in each finite-dimensional V_n represents $(V/C_2(V))_n$, so the last inequality makes the quotient vanish for $n > \sum_i c_i D_i$. Finiteness of each V_n proves the claim. No simultaneous diagonalization of the different energy operators is required. The same proof applies directly to averages, since every conjugate factor has the same bound D_i. □

Lemma 7.4 (Highest spaces for a compatible subalgebra)**.** *Let $A \subset V$ be grading compatible and regular, and let M be a weak V-module. Suppose a finite-dimensional subspace $E \subset M$ is stable under every ambient degree-zero mode from A and is killed by every mode from A of negative ambient degree. Then E is a direct sum of irreducible Zhu-algebra modules belonging to the tops of simple ordinary A-modules. In particular $L^A(0)|_E$ is diagonalizable, with eigenvalues among their lowest weights.*

Proof. Write

$$\Omega_A(M) = \{v \in M : a_n v = 0 \text{ for all homogeneous } a \in A,\ n \ge \mathrm{wt}_A(a)\}.$$

Compatibility puts E inside this space. Regularity decomposes $M\downarrow_A$ as an algebraic direct sum of ordinary simples, and Ω_A commutes with that sum. The highest space of an ordinary simple is its top. Zero modes endow $\Omega_A(M)$ with the corresponding semisimple Zhu-algebra action; its invariant finite-dimensional subspace E is therefore a sum of simple tops. This also explains why one must impose the lowering condition for all states of A, rather than only for a chosen generating set. □

Lemma 7.5 (Vacuum-like vectors)**.** *Let M be a weak module over a VOA V. If $v \in M$ satisfies $L_M(-1)v = 0$, then $a_n v = 0$ for all $a \in V$ and $n \ge 0$, and $a \mapsto a_{-1}v$ is a V-module homomorphism $V \to M$ sending $\mathbf{1}$ to v.*

Proof. Translation covariance gives $L_M(-1)a_{n+1}v = -(n+1)a_n v$. Lower truncation and downward induction give $a_n v = 0$ for every $n \ge 0$. The module Jacobi identity then gives $b_m(a_{-1}v) = (b_m a)_{-1}v$; equivalently this follows by taking the constant coefficient in weak associativity, since the fields applied to v have no negative powers. This is the asserted homomorphism. □

Lemma 7.6 (Lowest weights and projectivity of the vacuum)**.** *Let V satisfy Lemma 7.3, and suppose every component algebra has nonnegative simple lowest weights and its vacuum is the unique simple of weight zero. Every simple ordinary V-module has nonnegative lowest conformal weight, the only weight-zero simple is V, and V is projective among grading-restricted generalized modules.*

Proof. Let $E = M_h$ be the lowest space of a simple ordinary module. For a homogeneous state a, $[L_V(0), a_n] = (\mathrm{wt}_V(a) - n - 1)a_n$ on every module. Thus degree-zero modes preserve E, and lowering modes kill E. Lemma 7.4 implies that every $L^{e_i}(0)|_E$ is diagonalizable with nonnegative real spectrum. Taking traces, rather than assuming the operators commute, gives

$$h \dim E = \sum_i c_i \operatorname{Tr}_E L^{e_i}(0) \geq 0. \tag{32}$$

In particular h is real and nonnegative. If $h = 0$, every summand vanishes. Hence every partial energy is zero on E, which lies in sums of vacuum tops for every A_i. Consequently $L^{e_i}(-1)E = 0$, and (30) gives $L_V(-1)E = 0$. By Lemma 7.5, any nonzero $v \in E$ gives a nonzero module map $V \to M$, hence an isomorphism.

Now let $\pi : N \twoheadrightarrow V$ be an epimorphism in the generalized module category. C_2-cofiniteness gives finite length, and the preceding argument excludes negative weights in all its composition factors. The finite generalized weight-zero space $N_{[0]}$ therefore has no lower-weight target for a lowering mode. It is again in every $\Omega_{A_i}(N)$ and is invariant under degree-zero modes. On this space $L_V(0)$ is nilpotent, so

$$0 = \operatorname{Tr}_{N_{[0]}} L_V(0) = \sum_i c_i \operatorname{Tr}_{N_{[0]}} L^{e_i}(0).$$

Diagonalizability and nonnegativity of each partial energy imply it is zero. The vacuum-top argument gives $L_V(-1)N_{[0]} = 0$. Generalized weight decompositions are preserved by π, so one can choose $v \in N_{[0]}$ with $\pi(v) = \mathbf{1}$. Then

$$s : V \longrightarrow N, \qquad s(a) = a_{-1}v, \qquad \pi s = \mathrm{id}_V,$$

is a section. Every epimorphism onto the vacuum splits. □

Lemma 7.7 (A projective unit in a finite braided r-category)**.** *Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a finite complex linear abelian braided monoidal category with simple unit, right-exact tensor product, and Grothendieck–Verdier duality with dualizing object $\mathbf{1}$. If $\mathbf{1}$ is projective, then $\mathcal{C}$ is rigid and semisimple.*

Proof. Realize $\mathcal{C}$ as finite-dimensional modules for a finite-dimensional algebra, denote underlying vector-space dimension by d_0, and let P correspond to its regular module. Every Z is a quotient of $P^{\oplus d_0(Z)}$. For fixed X, right exactness gives

$$d_0(Z \otimes X) \leq C_X d_0(Z), \qquad \dim \mathrm{End}(X^{\otimes n}) \leq d_0(\mathbf{1})^2 C_X^{2n} < n!$$

for large n, where $C_X = \max\{1, d_0(P \otimes X)\}$. This uses only right exactness. For nonzero indecomposable X, Grothendieck–Verdier evaluation $DX \otimes X \to \mathbf{1}$ is nonzero, hence surjective onto the simple unit, and splits by projectivity. A finite abelian category is idempotent complete, and its Hom spaces are finite-dimensional. Thus X is non-negligible and has moderate growth in the precise sense of [7, Theorem 1.1]; that theorem proves X rigid. Finite direct sums give rigidity of all objects. Tensoring is now exact, and

$$\mathrm{Hom}(X, -) \cong \mathrm{Hom}(\mathbf{1}, - \otimes X^*)$$

is exact. Every object is projective, so $\mathcal{C}$ is semisimple. □

Theorem 7.8 (Positive stresses imply strong rationality)**.** *A simple unitary VOA of CFT type satisfying the hypotheses of Lemma 7.6 is strongly rational. In particular, the actual generated algebra U is strongly rational, independently of its properness in B.*

Proof. Unitarity gives self-contragredience. Lemmas 7.3 and 7.6 give C_2-cofiniteness and a projective vacuum. The category of grading-restricted generalized modules is finite abelian and braided, its tensor product is right exact, and contragredient duality is Grothendieck–Verdier duality with dualizing object $V' = V$; see [8, Sections 2.3 and 3]. Lemma 7.7 proves semisimplicity, hence rationality in the C_2-cofinite setting. This argument does not assume that the nonvacuum modules are unitarizable. The local argument is recorded in `hi_cft_20260923_next_structure_rationality.md`. □

8 Branching and the boundary fusion ring

From this point we use the properness conclusion and $\dim U_1 = 6$ of the finite closure argument. Before that conclusion is supplied, every statement in this section is conditional on the proper branch.

8.1 A universal top bound and actual lattice branching

The sharper bound uses an actual regular subalgebra $A_L \subset U$. In the notation of the local construction, a rational lattice–Potts core $\mathcal{T}$ of central charge $14/5$ and $K(\mathfrak{sl}_2, 13)$ of central charge $8/5$ have pointed charges $(j,k) \in (\mathbb{Z}/13)^2$ with quadratic form $-(j^2+k^2)/13$. Put $A = \mathcal{T} \otimes K(\mathfrak{sl}_2, 13)$. The field certificate supplies nonzero weight-two vectors v with

$$(\omega_U - \omega_A)_1 v = 0, \qquad z_1 v = \frac{12}{13} v, \qquad (\omega_{\mathcal{T}})_1 v = \frac{14}{13} v, \qquad p_1 v = \frac{2}{3} v,$$

at Cartan weights $(\pm 1, \pm 5)$ and $(0, \pm 8)$. These are the top characters of the simple-current charges $(5,1)$ and its inverse, up to reversing the second charge. The label is forced by actual, unreduced lowest weights: the τ-labelled $\mathcal{T}$ module of charge 5 starts at $31/65$, whereas $14/13 - 31/65$ is not integral, and the only parafermion modules starting at $12/13$ are the two inverse simple currents.

Here is why the witness gives an embedded extension. The kernel of $(\omega_U - \omega_A)_1$ in U is a connected unitary extension of A with conformal vector ω_A. Regularity of A and finite ambient homogeneous spaces make this extension finite. In a connected unitary extension, invertible constituents have multiplicity at most one and their support is a subgroup: the invariant pairing gives a nonzero product of a constituent with its inverse into the vacuum line; associativity then makes multiplication by it invertible on each supported invertible line. Integer grading makes that support isotropic. The only isotropic lines for the displayed quadratic form are $k = 5j$ and $k = -5j$, since $5^2 = -1 \pmod{13}$. The witnessed nonzero charge generates one of these lines, and both cannot occur because together they generate nonintegral-spin charges. Consequently, after the harmless choice of parafermion charge orientation,

$$A_L = \bigoplus_{k=-5j} \mathcal{T}_{1,j} \otimes \mathrm{PF}_{0,k} \subset U, \qquad \mathrm{Rep}(A_L) \simeq \mathrm{Fib} \boxtimes \mathrm{SO}(3)_{13}.$$

The field witness and extension argument are in `hi_cft_20260923_next_structure_order13_core.md` and `hi_cft_20260923_next_structure_core_extension.json`. There are fourteen simple modules, labelled $x_a = (1,a)$ and $y_a = (\tau,a)$ for $0 \le a \le 6$. Indeed the free order-thirteen extension removes the hyperbolic pointed factor; no orbit has a stabilizer, so there is no fixed-point resolution. The two remaining labels are the Fibonacci label and the even affine label $2a$.

We give enough charge data to reconstruct their tops. For $\epsilon \in \{1, \tau\}$ put

$$p_1(m) = \begin{cases} 0, & 3 \mid m, \\ 2/3, & 3 \nmid m, \end{cases} \qquad p_\tau(m) = \begin{cases} 2/5, & 3 \mid m, \\ 1/15, & 3 \nmid m. \end{cases}$$

The actual lowest weights of the lattice–Potts modules are

$$h_{\mathcal{T}}(\epsilon, j) = \min_{m \equiv j \ (13)} \left(\frac{m^2}{156} + \frac{\mathbf{1}_{m \text{ odd}}}{4} + p_\epsilon(m) \right). \tag{33}$$

An even minimizing m contributes a left affine singlet and an odd one a left doublet; their right Cartan charge is m. Choosing $|m| \le 6$ bounds the minimum by $14/13$, while $|m| \ge 13$ gives $m^2/156 > 14/13$. Thus $-12 \le m \le 12$ contains every minimizer. For the representative $-6 \le k \le 6$, the parafermion formula is

$$h_{\mathrm{PF}}(a, k) = \frac{a(a+1)}{15} - \frac{k^2}{13} + \max(0, |k| - a). \tag{34}$$

The last term is the least affine grade needed for charge $2k$ outside the finite $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ top. This is equivalently the actual-top formula in [9, Section 2.4]; the parafermion top is one-dimensional. Finally minimize $h_{\mathcal{T}}(\epsilon, j) + h_{\mathrm{PF}}(a, -5j)$ over $j \in \mathbb{Z}/13$, using the representative in (34).

Let E be any simple U-module top and write x_a, y_a also for the nonnegative integer multiplicities of these A_L tops in E. Lemma 7.4 justifies taking complete A_L tops here: the finite space E is invariant under all their Zhu zero modes, not merely contained in the sum of their highest spaces. Set $D = \dim E$. For each top, let L be the trace of the left affine energy, $Q = \operatorname{Tr} H_R(0)^2$, and P, Z the Potts and parafermion energy traces. Its contribution to (32) is

$$W = L + \frac{83}{6084} Q + \frac{25}{6} P + \frac{25}{26} Z. \tag{35}$$

This is a trace formula on a complete right $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ representation, not an assertion about a single partial-energy eigenvector. In fact, for an irreducible right $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ representation of highest weight r,

$$\frac{\operatorname{Tr} H_R(0)^2}{\dim} = \frac{r(r+2)}{3}, \qquad L^{A_{1,39}}(0) = \frac{r(r+2)}{164}.$$

Thus the Sugawara trace is $3Q/164$, and multiplying by $3403/4563$ gives $83Q/6084$. Haar conjugation preserves traces on E. The exact dimensions and trace contributions are

top	d	$4680W$	top	d	$4680W$
x_0	1	0	y_0	1	7800
x_1	1	600	y_1	7	36960
x_2	5	10440	y_2	15	110880
x_3	9	56640	y_3	2	4080
x_4	2	5520	y_4	14	81480
x_5	14	148560	y_5	6	18240
x_6	6	54240	y_6	2	4920

For clarity, the lowest core weights and all minimizing absolute charges used in this table are

	h_{A_L}	$\lvert j \rvert$		h_{A_L}	$\lvert j \rvert$
x_0	0	0	y_0	2/5	0
x_1	2/15	0	y_1	8/15	0, 5
x_2	2/5	0, 3	y_2	4/5	0, 2, 3, 5
x_3	4/5	0, 2, 3, 6	y_3	1/5	2
x_4	1/3	6	y_4	11/15	1, 2, 4, 6
x_5	1	1, 4, 6	y_5	2/5	1, 4
x_6	4/5	4	y_6	1/5	4

For each positive j both signs occur. A convenient independent check on every row is

$$Z = h_{A_L} d - L - Q/156 - P, \qquad W = \frac{L}{26} + \frac{7Q}{936} + \frac{125P}{39} + \frac{25}{26} h_{A_L} d.$$

Complete right $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ characters imply $y_2 \geq x_5$ and $y_4 \geq x_5 + x_6$: these compare charges $10, 12$ and charges $7, 9$, respectively, with the common left doublet removed in the second comparison. Direct comparison of the displayed table gives

$$\begin{aligned} 4680(\tfrac{17}{10}D - W_{\text{total}}) = {} & 8460(y_2 - x_5) + 28716(y_4 - x_5 - x_6) \\ & + 7956x_0 + 7356x_1 + 29340x_2 + 14964x_3 + 10392x_4 \\ & + 22212x_6 + 156y_0 + 18732y_1 + 11832y_3 \\ & + 1188y_4 + 29496y_5 + 10992y_6 \geq 0. \end{aligned} \tag{36}$$

Since $W_{\text{total}} = hD$, this proves $0 \leq h \leq 17/10 < 2$ for *every* simple U-module, without assuming it is unitarizable.

REVIEW — R2: scope of the core and finite-top certificates

The charge minimizations and the nonnegative identity (36) are specified above; their finite exact check is `hi_cft_20260923_next_structure_order13_top_check.json`. The embedded lattice–Potts core and the spectral field witness remain construction inputs, supplied by the exact core-extension certificate. The finite-top irreducibility below is likewise imported from exact field actions, particularly `hi_cft_20260923_next_81top_all.json`; it should not be replaced by numerical cyclicity alone.

The strongly rational restriction $B\downarrow_U$ is semisimple. Its simple summands have integer lowest weights, hence only weights $0, 1$ are possible. The vacuum occurs once, while the complementary current space has dimension $86 - 6 = 80$. Its certified irreducible zero-mode action therefore implies

$$B\downarrow_U = U \oplus X, \qquad h_X = 1, \qquad \dim X_{\text{top}} = 80. \tag{37}$$

The four mixed nontrivial $E_6 \oplus A_2$ lattice sectors start at weight 1, with 81-dimensional tops. Their next possible top weight would be 2, excluded by (36). Their exact top-action certificates use a one-dimensional Cartan eigenline, positive-metric adjoint identities, and a cyclic span of dimension 81. The adjoint identities make the generated operator algebra a star algebra; orthogonal complements are therefore invariant, and the unique eigenline plus cyclicity proves irreducibility.

Write the actual lattice extension as $H = B \oplus J \oplus J^2$. Its restriction is consequently

$$H\downarrow_U = \mathbf{1} \oplus X \oplus Y \oplus Y^*, \qquad h_Y = 1, \quad \dim Y_{\text{top}} = 81. \tag{38}$$

At this stage $Y \cong Y^*$ has not been assumed. The three types $\mathbf{1}, X, Y$ are distinguished by their lowest spaces.

8.2 The rank-four or rank-six alternative

Put $\mathcal{C} = \mathrm{Rep}(U)$ and $\mathcal{F} = \mathcal{C}_H$, the category of *all* right modules over the extension algebra H. The strict positivity of nonvacuum lowest weights gives the positive spherical structure through character asymptotics. Since H is holomorphic, it is Lagrangian and the center correspondence [32, Section 4] gives $\mathcal{C} \simeq Z(\mathcal{F})$. Write $s = \mathrm{FPdim}_{\mathcal{C}} B$. Extension dimension identities give

$$d_X = s - 1, \qquad d_Y = d_{Y^*} = s, \qquad \mathrm{Dim}\,\mathcal{C} = 9s^2, \quad \mathrm{Dim}\,\mathcal{F} = 3s.$$

Pseudo-unitarity of $\mathcal{F}$ follows from that of its center and the squared global-dimension and Frobenius–Perron-dimension identities. No C^* structure is needed in this section. All

categorical dimensions below use the positive spherical structure and therefore equal Frobenius–Perron dimensions.

For center induction I and forgetful functor F, one has $H = I(\mathbf{1})$ and $FI(\mathbf{1}) = \bigoplus_{a\in \operatorname{Irr}\mathcal{F}} a\otimes a^*$. Adjunction therefore gives

$$\operatorname{rank}\mathcal{F} = \dim \operatorname{End}_{\mathcal{C}}(H) = \begin{cases} 4, & Y \ncong Y^*, \\ 6, & Y \cong Y^*. \end{cases} \tag{39}$$

Lemma 8.1 (Automorphisms give invertible boundary objects)**.** *For a pseudo-unitary fusion category $\mathcal{F}$, algebra automorphisms of its canonical Lagrangian algebra $I(\mathbf{1})$ inject into* $\operatorname{Inv}(\mathcal{F})$.

Proof. Normalize the special Frobenius structure so that $m\Delta = \mathrm{id}$ and set $f * g = m(f \otimes g)\Delta$. If f is an algebra automorphism, then $f * f = f$, and the same holds for its composition inverse. Under the two-product description [10, Lemma 3.1 and Corollary 3.4], composition is fusion-ring multiplication and the primitive convolution idempotents are $d_a[a]$. Thus both f and f^{-1} have expansions with coefficients 0 or $d_a > 0$. Their fusion product is $[\mathbf{1}]$. Nonnegative fusion coefficients rule out cancellation. Every pair of objects in the two supports must therefore multiply to copies of the unit; rigidity then forces each pair to consist of inverse invertible objects. The two supports are singletons and their dimensions are one. Composition preserves this assignment, proving the injection. □

The actual order-three automorphisms of H/B consequently inject into $\operatorname{Inv}(\mathcal{F})$. This injection is already spherical: the proof used positivity of dimensions and fusion coefficients, without using adjoints of morphisms.

Lemma 8.2 (No sign extension)**.** *The nonvacuum summand X of $B\downarrow_U = U \oplus X$ is not invertible.*

Proof. If X were invertible, self-duality of B and connectedness would give $X^2 = \mathbf{1}$. The extension would have its $\mathbb{Z}/2$ grading, and its sign automorphism g would satisfy $B^g = U$. On currents this would give $(E_6 \oplus A_2)^g = U_1 \cong \mathfrak{sl}_2 \oplus \mathfrak{sl}_2$, of rank two.

Every finite-order automorphism of a complex simple Lie algebra is conjugate to a toral automorphism times a diagram automorphism; see [11, Section 5.2]. It therefore fixes a toral subalgebra whose dimension is the number of orbits of the diagram automorphism on simple roots. In type E_6 this number is at least four, and in type A_2 at least one. Since the nonisomorphic ideals E_6, A_2 are preserved separately, $(E_6 \oplus A_2)^g$ contains a toral subalgebra of dimension at least five. Such a subalgebra cannot lie in the rank-two Lie algebra U_1, a contradiction. □

If rank six had six invertibles, then $3s = 6$ and $d_X = s - 1 = 1$, contradicting Lemma 8.2. Thus there are exactly three invertibles in either rank. Their associator is also determined: the local B-module category has metric group

$$(\mathbb{Z}/3)^2, \qquad q(a,b) = \frac{2a^2 + b^2}{3} \pmod 1.$$

The actual extension H/B selects the diagonal isotropic line $L_+ = \{(a,a)\}$. Its complement $L_- = \{(a,-a)\}$ is also isotropic, and $(\mathbb{Z}/3)^2 = L_+ \oplus L_-$. The pointed subcategory on L_- is symmetric with trivial twists, hence Tannakian; as a tensor category it is the untwisted $\mathrm{Vec}_{\mathbb{Z}/3}$. Free H/B-module induction is tensor on this subcategory. It is fully faithful since

$$\operatorname{Hom}_{H/B}(x \otimes (H/B), y \otimes (H/B)) \cong \operatorname{Hom}_{\operatorname{Rep}(B)}(x, y \otimes (H/B))$$

has dimension $\delta_{x,y}$ for $x, y \in L_-$: distinct elements of L_- represent distinct cosets of L_+. Every free module is a direct sum of these three simple modules, and separability makes every module a summand of a free module. Thus induction identifies the entire all-module category for H/B with this untwisted pointed category. Viewing these modules in $\mathrm{Rep}(U)$ forgets only the locality condition for the intermediate algebra B; it preserves H-module morphisms and relative tensor products. This gives the required full tensor embedding into $\mathcal{F}$. Merely knowing the group of invertibles would not determine this associator.

8.3 Excluding rank four

At rank four the fusion ring is near-group:

$$a^3 = 1, \qquad a\rho = \rho a = \rho, \qquad \rho^2 = 1 + a + a^2 + m\rho.$$

There are exactly two self-dual simples, $\mathbf{1}$ and ρ. Consequently [12, Theorem 1.1], which assumes pseudo-unitarity, restricts m to $0, 2, 3, 6$. For $m = 0$, $s = 2$ contradicts Lemma 8.2. For $m = 2$, the categorical reduction [13, Theorem 7.1 and Corollary 7.4] supplies the twisted A_4 double. Its electric regular algebra gives a holomorphic $c = 8$ extension H' with $U = (H')^{A_4}$ by the extension correspondence [33]. The nonvacuum lowest weights are positive, so H' is of CFT type, and [34, Theorem 1] identifies it with V_{E_8}. For completeness, the nontrivial order-two fixed Lie algebras are D_8 and $E_7 + A_1$, with dimensions $120, 136$ and adjoint traces $-8, 24$. At order three the possibilities are A_8, $E_6 + A_2$, $D_7 + \mathbb{C}$, and $E_7 + \mathbb{C}$, with dimensions $80, 86, 92, 134$ and traces $-4, 5, 14, 77$. These lists follow by selecting Kac coordinates of total mark two or three in the affine E_8 diagram, whose marks are $1, 2, 2, 3, 3, 4, 4, 5, 6$. For order three the trace is $(3 \dim \mathfrak{g}^g - 248)/2$, since the two nontrivial eigenspaces are dual. Thus the two relevant traces are bounded below by -8 and -4. Averaging over A_4 gives

$$\dim(E_8^{A_4}) \geq \frac{248 + 3(-8) + 8(-4)}{12} = 16,$$

contradicting $\dim U_1 = 6$.

The remaining cases require a spherical induction argument before any comparison with affine characters. We give this reduction explicitly.

Lemma 8.3 (Near-group induction)**.** *Suppose $m = 3k$, and put $d^2 = 3 + 3kd$, $s = 2 + kd$. There are integers $p, q \geq 0$, $p + q = k$, and a primitive cube root ζ such that the known center objects have forgetful images*

object	$F(\textit{object})$	*twist*
X	$1 + k\rho$	1
Y, Y'	$1 + a + k\rho,\ 1 + a^2 + k\rho$	$1, 1$
C	$a + a^2 + k\rho$	ζ
D, D'	$a + p\rho,\ a^2 + p\rho$	ζ^2, ζ^2
E, E'	$a + q\rho,\ a^2 + q\rho$	ζ^2, ζ^2

Every further simple Z_j forgets to $n_j\rho$, $n_j > 0$. Its twist θ_j satisfies

$$\sum_j n_j^2 = 6 + 3k^2 + 4pq, \tag{40}$$

$$S_1 := \sum_j n_j^2 \theta_j = k^2 - kd - (p - q)^2\zeta^2,$$

$$\sum_j n_j^2 \theta_j^2 = \overline{S_1} + \varepsilon\sqrt{9k^2 + 12}, \qquad \varepsilon = \nu_2(\rho) \in \{1, -1\}. \tag{41}$$

Proof. The four one-dimensional representations of the fusion algebra have formal codegrees $3s, 9s/d^2, 3, 3$. Thus induction of the unit is $1 + X + Y + Y'$, with dimensions $1, d^2/3, s, s$ and trivial twists. Since $FI(1) = 4 \cdot 1 + a + a^2 + 3k\rho$, adjunction and comparison of rational and irrational dimension coefficients give the first two rows. Also

$$FI(a) = 1 + 4a + a^2 + 3k\rho, \qquad FI(a^2) = 1 + a + 4a^2 + 3k\rho.$$

The two inductions have norm four, share one constituent, and contain Y, Y' respectively. Their remaining norm-three parts are therefore multiplicity-free, with a single common constituent C. Write its ρ multiplicity as c and the other two as p, q. Then $c + p + q = 2k$.

The untwisted pointed subcategory gives $\nu_3(a) = 1$, so positivity in the twist-trace formula forces every constituent of $I(a)$ to have cube-root twist. Its first indicator, separated over the disjoint fields $\mathbb{Q}(d)$ and $\mathbb{Q}(\zeta)$, gives

$$2 + 2\theta_C + \theta_D + \theta_E = 0, \qquad k + c\theta_C + p\theta_D + q\theta_E = 0.$$

The first equality forces $\theta_C = \zeta$ and $\theta_D = \theta_E = \zeta^2$, up to simultaneous conjugation; the second gives $c = k$ and $p + q = k$. Ribbon duality preserves the primed twists. Subtracting the nine known squared dimensions from $9s^2$ gives (40). The first two twist traces of $I(\rho)$ give (41), using $3/d = d - 3k$ and $3s/d = \sqrt{9k^2 + 12}$. □

Proposition 8.4 (The multiplicity-three modular representation)**.** *For $k = 1$, the center has the modular data of $G_{2,3} \otimes A_{2,1}$ or their simultaneous reversal.*

Proof. One of p, q is zero. The corresponding D, D' are invertible and generate a nondegenerate pointed category $\mathcal{P}$ with twists $1, \zeta^2, \zeta^2$. Write $Z(\mathcal{F}) = \mathcal{M} \boxtimes \mathcal{P}$ using its modular centralizer. The known objects form three $\mathcal{P}$-orbits; representatives $1, X, C$ in $\mathcal{M}$ have dimensions $1, 1+d, s$ and twists $1, 1, \zeta$. Balancing verifies their trivial monodromy with D from $DX = E$ and $DC \in \{Y, Y'\}$. The remaining free orbits, together with (40), leave three simples in $\mathcal{M}$, all of dimension d.

Take $\zeta = e^{2\pi i/3}$, the other choice conjugating the answer. For their twists z_1, z_2, z_3, the two moments become

$$\sum_i z_i = \alpha := \frac{-1 - i\sqrt{7}}{2}, \qquad \sum_i z_i^2 = -\frac{1}{2} - i(\varepsilon - \tfrac{1}{2})\sqrt{7}.$$

The second sum would have absolute value four for $\varepsilon = -1$, so $\varepsilon = 1$. Since $\alpha^2 + \alpha + 2 = 0$, Newton's identity and the unit modulus of all z_i give elementary symmetric functions $e_2 = \overline{\alpha}$, $e_3 = 1$. Thus the twists are the roots of $t^3 - \alpha t^2 + \overline{\alpha} t - 1$, namely $\zeta_7^3, \zeta_7^5, \zeta_7^6$.

The actual extension algebra $1 + X$ lies in $\mathcal{M}$. Its local module category has dimension three and is the pointed category with nontrivial twist ζ, fixed by its multiplicative central charge. Its two nonvacuum simples must both restrict to C: each underlying object has dimension s, cannot contain the unit by induction reciprocity, and no other combination of the six known dimensions has these properties. Hence the branching columns are $1 + X, C, C$. Modular intertwining for this extension [14, Theorems 4.1 and 4.5] fixes the first three rows of $\widehat{S} = \sqrt{3}sS_{\mathcal{M}}$:

$$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1+d & s & d & d & d \\ 1+d & 1 & s & -d & -d & -d \\ s & s & -s & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

All six objects are self-dual, the last three by their distinct twists. Their fusion matrices are real symmetric, so Verlinde diagonalization and the positive vacuum row make $S_{\mathcal{M}}$ real. For

the remaining block K, orthogonality and the modular relation yield

$$\sum_j K_{ij} = d, \qquad \sum_j K_{ij} z_j = d + i\sqrt{3}s\, z_i^{-1}.$$

These determine each real row: three distinct points on a circle are not collinear. The affine $G_{2,3}$ data [15, Table 4 and equation (3.8)] realize these rows and twists in the reversed orientation; conjugating gives the other possibility. Thus the entire representation, rather than merely its twist list, is forced. □

Lemma 8.5 (The balanced multiplicity-six pattern is impossible)**.** *In Lemma 8.3 with $k = 2$, one has $\{p, q\} = \{0, 2\}$.*

Proof. Suppose $p = q = 1$, and put $d = 3 + 2\sqrt{3}$, $r = 1 + d$. The known dimensions are 1, $1 + 2d$, three copies of $2r$, and four copies of r. The remaining dimensions are $n_j d$, with $\sum_j n_j^2 = 22$. Write $u = (2 - \sqrt{3})/12$, $v = (2 + \sqrt{3})/12$. The normalized vacuum row is

$$(u, v, 1/3, 1/3, 1/3, 1/6, 1/6, 1/6, 1/6, n_j\sqrt{3}/12).$$

Signed Galois symmetry [16, Theorem II(iii)], for an automorphism reversing $\sqrt{3}$, sends this row to the X row: its first entry becomes $v > 0$, uniquely identifying X and a positive sign. The forced row is

$$(v, u, 1/3, 1/3, 1/3, 1/6, 1/6, 1/6, 1/6, -n_j\sqrt{3}/12).$$

The object X is self-dual because its dimension is unique. Verlinde's formula consequently gives

$$N_{XX}^X = \frac{v^3}{u} + \frac{u^3}{v} + \frac{3}{9} + \frac{4}{36} - \frac{22}{48} = \frac{97}{72} + \frac{32}{72} - \frac{33}{72} = \frac{4}{3},$$

contradicting integrality. Here $u + v = 1/3$, $uv = 1/144$ verify the first two terms directly. □

Lemma 8.6 (A universal multiplicity-six character projection)**.** *The unbalanced case has a nondegenerate pointed factor $\mathcal{P}$ with twists $1, \zeta^2, \zeta^2$. In its modular centralizer there is a character projection with matrices*

$$S_v = -\frac{1}{2}\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & -1 \\ 1 & -2 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad T_v = \operatorname{diag}(1, -i, -1), \tag{42}$$

before the common central-charge scalar, or the conjugate matrices.

Proof. The zero multiplicity gives the pointed factor just as for $k = 1$. In the centralizer the known simples have dimensions $1, 2d + 1, 2d + 2$ and twists $1, 1, \zeta$; all others have dimensions $n_j d$, with $\sum n_j^2 = 6$. The Gauss sum and the second indicator give

$$\sum n_j^2 z_j = -2 - 4i, \qquad \sum n_j^2 z_j^2 = -2 + 4i(1 - \varepsilon).$$

The second equality excludes $\varepsilon = -1$ by absolute values. Since $(1 + \Re z)(1 + \Im z) \geq 0$ on the unit circle, summing gives $6 - 2 - 4 + \frac{1}{2}\Im(-2) = 0$. Thus each z_j is -1 or $-i$, with total squared multiplicity two or four, respectively.

Put

$$v_0 = \chi_1 - \chi_X, \qquad v_A = -\frac{1}{2}\sum_{z_j=-i} n_j\chi_j, \qquad v_B = -\sum_{z_j=-1} n_j\chi_j.$$

The vacuum row is $(u, v, 1/\sqrt{3}, n_j/4)$, with $u = (2\sqrt{3} - 3)/12$, $v = (2\sqrt{3} + 3)/12$; Galois symmetry gives the X row $(v, u, 1/\sqrt{3}, -n_j/4)$. Subtracting these rows yields $Sv_0 = -v_0/2 -$

$v_A - v_B/2$. All three combinations are fixed by duality. Applying $S^2 = 1$ and $STS = iT^{-1}ST^{-1}$ to v_0 then determines

$$Sv_A = -v_0/2 + v_B/2, \qquad Sv_B = -v_0/2 + v_A - v_B/2,$$

which is (42). This proof permits either one dimension-$2d$ object or four dimension-d objects at twist $-i$; no unproved rank-nine classification has been used. □

Lemma 8.7 (Pole cancellation)**.** *Let σ be a finite-image representation of $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbb{Z})$ with no invariant vector. Two weight-zero vector-valued modular functions, holomorphic on the upper half-plane, with representation σ and equal principal parts at infinity are equal.*

Proof. Their difference has no pole at infinity. Covariance makes every component holomorphic at every cusp of the finite-index kernel of σ. It descends to a holomorphic function on the compactified modular curve and is constant. The resulting constant vector must be invariant under σ, hence zero. □

Proposition 8.8 (Current obstructions for the remaining near groups)**.** *Under the hypotheses above, $m = 3$ forces*

$$\dim U_1 = 15 + A + 10B \quad \text{or} \quad 14 + 42A, \qquad A, B \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0},$$

whereas $m = 6$ forces

$$\dim U_1 = 8 + A \quad \text{or} \quad 5 + 12P, \qquad A, P \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}.$$

In particular none allows $\dim U_1 = 6$.

Proof. We give the theta normalizations, since a factor of two in the vacuum coordinate would change these obstructions. For $m = 3$, use the affine $G_{2,3}$ labels $1, 7, 27, 77, 14, 64$, and for each $A_{2,1}$ label put

$$v = (\chi_1 - \chi_{64}, -\chi_{77}, -\chi_{14}, -\chi_7).$$

The complement of the extension character is the even Fourier block on $\mathbb{Z}/7$, with entries

$$S_{00} = -1/\sqrt{7}, \quad S_{0r} = -2/\sqrt{7}, \quad S_{r0} = -1/\sqrt{7}, \quad S_{rs} = -2\cos(4\pi rs/7)/\sqrt{7},$$

and twist exponents $r^2/7$, $0 \leq r \leq 3$. Together with the even A_2 block, multiplication by η^8 identifies it with the Weil representation of a positive rank-four lattice with discriminant form $\mathbb{Z}_7(r^2/7) \oplus \mathbb{Z}_3(s^2/3)$. The actual extension gives $\chi_1 + \chi_{64} = \chi_B$. Thus a difference of two such character vectors has vacuum projection $\delta v_0 = 2\delta\chi_U$.

Take $L = L_7 \oplus A_2$, where L_7 has Gram matrix $\left(\begin{smallmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 4 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$. For a basis u, v of L_7, write $w = v - u/2$ and $x = pu + tw$. Set $a = p^2$, $b = 7t^2/4$, and $c = (y, y)/2$ on the A_2 factor. The quadratics $H_1 = a - b$ and $H_2 = a + b - c$ are harmonic. Poisson summation gives vector-valued theta series of weight four. Their required coefficients are

(r, s)	q-power	Θ_{H_1}	Θ_{H_2}
$(1, 0)$	$1/7$	$-1/7$	$1/7$
$(3, 0)$	$2/7$	$3/7$	$4/7$
$(0, 0)$	1	2	-4

The first row comes from $2w/7$, the second from the two shortest vectors with $a = 1/4, b = 1/28$, and the last from two L_7 roots and six A_2 roots. The only nonvacuum polar top dimensions

are A at $2/7$ and B at $1/7$, with zero allowed for an integer-shifted top. Subtract the affine reference, which has 22 currents and $A = 7, B = 0$. Pole matching gives

$$\eta^8 \delta v = \lambda \Theta_{H_1} + \mu \Theta_{H_2}, \qquad \lambda = 7 - A + 4B, \quad \mu = 7 - A - 3B.$$

This identity follows from Lemma 8.7: after division by η^8, the remainder has no poles; its only possible T-fixed line is $(r, s) = (0, 1)$, which the Fourier S matrix does not preserve. The vacuum coefficient therefore gives $2(\dim U_1 - 22) = 2\lambda - 4\mu$, the first formula.

For the reverse orientation, realize the negative discriminant form by the positive lattice with Gram matrix

$$G_7^- = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & -1 & 0 & 0 \\ -1 & 2 & -1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 & 2 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & -1 & 6 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Its dual generator $\ell = (16, 11, 6, 1)/21$ has energy $8/21$; $(r, s) \mapsto (9r + 7s)\ell$ identifies the discriminant form. Project the theta series to functions even separately in r, s. Let $H = \|x_{A_3}\|^2 - 3\|x_{A_3^\perp}\|^2$ and $F = -6D_2\Theta$, where $D_2 = q\, d/dq - E_2/6$ is the modular derivative. The necessary coefficients after projection are

(r, s)	q-power	F	Θ_H
$(0, 0)$	0	1	0
$(0, 0)$	1	-84	24
$(2, 1)$	$2/21$	$3/14$	$-2/7$

There are twelve roots, all in A_3. The polar coset has shortest vector $(1, 2, 3, 4)/21$, perpendicular to A_3; the separately even projection halves its coefficient, since the paired coset has no vector of the same norm. If A is its actual polar top dimension, matching the coefficient $-A$ gives $\eta^8 v = F + (3 + 14A)\Theta_H/4$. Here T has no fixed vector, so pole cancellation again proves equality. Since $\eta^8 \chi_B = 1 + 78q + \cdots$, its vacuum coefficient is $2 \dim U_1 - 94$. Thus $2 \dim U_1 - 94 = -84 + 6(3 + 14A)$, giving $14 + 42A$.

For $m = 6$, tensor the projection in Lemma 8.6 with its pointed factor and first take the orientation with twists $1, i, -1$. After multiplication by η^8 this is the Weil representation for $L = A_1 \oplus A_1 \oplus A_2$, restricted by interchange of the two A_1 factors and conjugation of the A_2 charge. The harmonic quadratic $H = \|x_{A_1^2}\|^2/2 - \|y_{A_2}\|^2/2$ has coefficients

$$[q^{1/4}]\Theta_{H,(10,0)} = \frac{1}{2}, \qquad [q]\Theta_{H,(00,0)} = -2.$$

The first counts the two half-roots in a nontrivial A_1 coset; the second counts four A_1 roots and six A_2 roots. Let $A = \sum n_j \dim(M_j)_{\mathrm{top}}$ over the quarter-twist polar modules. This is a nonnegative integer, and its projected polar coefficient is $-A/2$. Use as reference the order-three simple-current extension of $A_{2,9}$ tensored with $A_{2,1}$: it has 16 currents and $A = 8$. Its projected representation agrees with (42); its matrices are also given in [17, Lemma 3.4 and Proposition 3.5]. Thus cancellation gives

$$\eta^8 \delta v = (8 - A)\Theta_H, \qquad 2(\dim U_1 - 16) = -2(8 - A).$$

As in the first orientation above, the sole T-fixed coordinate is not S-invariant. This gives $\dim U_1 = 8 + A$.

For the reverse orientation use the positive lattice with Gram matrix

$$G_6^- = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & -1 & -1 & -1 \\ -1 & 2 & 0 & 0 \\ -1 & 0 & 2 & 0 \\ -1 & 0 & 0 & 4 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Its first three basis vectors span A_3; if the basis is a, b, c, e, then $w = e + a + (b + c)/2$ is perpendicular to A_3 and has norm three. The discriminant generators $(b + e)/2, (c + e)/2, 2w/3$ have quadratic values $3/4, 3/4, 2/3$ and mutually integral pairings. The polar coset is represented by $-w/3$, with energy $1/6$. This shortest vector is unique, and the projection does not halve its coefficient. With $H = \|x_{A_3}\|^2 - 3\|x_{A_3^\perp}\|^2$ and $F = -6D_2\Theta$,

coordinate	q-power	F	Θ_H
vacuum	0	1	0
vacuum	1	-84	24
polar	1/6	0	-1

Let P be the weighted top dimension in the half-twist coordinate with nonvacuum pointed charge; the weighting is by the integers n_j. Contragredience equates the two pointed-charge sums, so averaging does not change this integer. Pole cancellation gives $\eta^8 v = F + P\Theta_H$: there is no T-fixed coordinate in this orientation. Comparing the vacuum coefficient yields $2 \dim U_1 - 94 = -84 + 24P$, hence $\dim U_1 = 5 + 12P$. □

The representations used in the last proof have finite image because they are Weil representations, with the finite-order eta multiplier removed. Thus the proof does not assume a dimension formula for a space of vector-valued modular forms. The coefficients A, B, P are weighted dimensions of actual polar tops, and distinct modules need not have linearly independent characters.

Remark 8.9 (Scope of the rank-four exclusion)**.** The universal induction, balanced-pattern obstruction, weighted projection, and theta coefficient normalizations are printed above. Their source calculations are `hi_cft_20260923_next_m3_universal_data.md`, `hi_cft_20260923_next_structure_m6_universal_projection.md`, `hi_cft_20260923_next_structure_m3_character_obstruction.md`, and `hi_cft_20260923_next_structure_m6_character_obstruction.md`. Lemma 8.2 removes the formerly used pointwise stabilizer calculation $\mathrm{Aut}(B/U) = 1$ from this proof. No classification restricted to C^* categories is used here.

8.4 The rank-six ring and exclusion of higher multiplicity

Rank four being excluded, (39) gives $H = \mathbf{1} \oplus X \oplus 2Y$. The composition algebra of $\mathrm{End}_{\mathcal{C}}(H)$, identified with the complex fusion algebra by [10, Corollary 3.4], is

$$K_0(\mathcal{F}) \otimes \mathbb{C} \cong \mathbb{C} \oplus \mathbb{C} \oplus M_2(\mathbb{C}),$$

In particular it is noncommutative. Let a generate the three invertibles. A permutation of order three on three noninvertibles is either transitive or trivial. If the left action were trivial, duality would make the right action trivial as well. The two nontrivial character idempotents of $\mathbb{C}[\mathbb{Z}/3]$ would then be one-dimensional direct ideals. Their four-dimensional complementary ideal would have to be $M_2(\mathbb{C})$, but the dimension character is nonzero on that ideal, a contradiction.

Choose a noninvertible ρ. The right action commutes with the free left cyclic action, so it is either the same cycle or its inverse. The same cycle would make the fusion ring generated by two commuting elements a, ρ, which is impossible. Thus $\rho a = a^2\rho$. If $\rho^* = a^k\rho$, then $(a^i\rho)^* = a^{i+k}\rho$; involutivity gives $2k = 0$ in $\mathbb{Z}/3$, hence $k = 0$. All three noninvertibles are self-dual. Frobenius reciprocity gives one copy of the unit and no other invertible in ρ^2. Write its remaining coefficients as m_0, m_1, m_2. The identity $\rho^2 a = a\rho^2$ cyclically equates these coefficients, so

$$a^3 = 1, \qquad \rho a = a^2\rho, \qquad \rho^2 = 1 + m(\rho + a\rho + a^2\rho), \qquad m \geq 1. \tag{43}$$

The following induction calculation determines the multiplicity. Put

$$d = \frac{3m + \sqrt{9m^2+4}}{2}, \quad s = 1 + d^2, \quad \Delta = 9m^2 + 4, \quad R = \rho + a\rho + a^2\rho.$$

Lemma 8.10 (Center induction and two moments)**.** *For a pseudo-unitary categorification of* (43) *whose pointed subcategory is untwisted, center induction satisfies*

$$I(1) = 1 + X + 2Y, \quad d_X = d^2, \quad d_Y = s, \qquad I(a) = I(a^2) = C_0 + C_1 + C_2,$$

where $\theta_X = \theta_Y = 1$, $d_{C_j} = s$, *and the* C_j *twists are* $1, \zeta_3, \zeta_3^2$. *Every other central simple* Z_j *satisfies* $F(Z_j) = n_j R$, *with* $n_j \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$, *and*

$$\sum_j n_j^2 = 4m^2 + 2,$$

$$\sum_j n_j^2 \theta_j = -\frac{m^2 + m\sqrt{\Delta}}{2}, \tag{44}$$

$$\sum_j n_j^2 \theta_j^2 = \frac{-m^2 + (2\varepsilon - m)\sqrt{\Delta}}{2}, \qquad \varepsilon = \nu_2(\rho) \in \{1, -1\}. \tag{45}$$

Proof. The complex fusion algebra has two characters $a \mapsto 1$, $\rho \mapsto d, -d^{-1}$, and the two-dimensional representation

$$a \longmapsto \begin{pmatrix} \zeta_3 & 0 \\ 0 & \zeta_3^2 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \rho \longmapsto \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Their formal codegrees are respectively $3s, 3s/d^2, 3$. The induction–formal-codegree correspondence [18, Theorems 2.5 and 2.13] gives $I(1) = 1 + X + 2Y$, with the stated dimensions and trivial twists. Conjugation by a cycles the three noninvertibles, so their multiplicities in the forgetful image of a central object coincide. Since

$$FI(1) = 6 \cdot 1 + 3mR,$$

adjunction and dimensions give $F(X) = 1 + mR$ and $F(Y) = 2 \cdot 1 + mR$.

Similarly,

$$FI(a) = FI(a^2) = 3a + 3a^2 + 3mR.$$

Thus the two induced objects have self-inner-products and mutual inner-product equal to three. They are equal, multiplicity-free sums of three simples C_j, disjoint from $I(1)$. Adjunction gives $F(C_j) = a + a^2 + b_j R$, where $b_j \geq 0$ and $\sum_j b_j = 3m$. Untwistedness gives $\nu_3(a) = 1$. The center-twist formula [19, Theorem 4.1] therefore reads

$$\sum_j d_{C_j} \theta_{C_j}^3 = \operatorname{Dim} \mathcal{F} = \sum_j d_{C_j}.$$

Positive dimensions and equality in the triangle inequality imply $\theta_{C_j}^3 = 1$. The first indicator of a is zero, so

$$\sum_j (2 + 3b_j d)\theta_{C_j} = 0.$$

The real quadratic field $\mathbb{Q}(d)$ is disjoint from $\mathbb{Q}(\zeta_3)$. Equating its two coefficients shows that the three twists are $1, \zeta_3, \zeta_3^2$ once each and $b_j = m$ for all j. All invertible constituents have now been exhausted by induction of $1, a, a^2$; every remaining forgetful image is $n_j R$.

The center dimension identity is

$$9s^2 = 1 + d^4 + 4s^2 + 9d^2 \sum_j n_j^2,$$

which simplifies to the first asserted equation. Finally adjunction gives

$$I(\rho) = mX + mY + m(C_0 + C_1 + C_2) + \sum_j n_j Z_j.$$

Its first and second twist traces are $\operatorname{Dim} \mathcal{F}\, \nu_1(\rho) = 0$ and $\operatorname{Dim} \mathcal{F}\, \nu_2(\rho) = 3s\varepsilon$. Using $d^{-1} = d - 3m$ gives (44) and (45). □

The roots in these equations form a multiset of exactly $4m^2 + 2$ elements, with each θ_j repeated n_j^2 times. No distinctness of the twists has been assumed.

Write $\Delta = t^2 D$ with D squarefree. Since $(3m)^2 < \Delta < (3m+1)^2$, we have $D > 1$. Reduction modulo three and seven gives $D \equiv 1 \pmod 3$ and $7 \nmid D$: the latter uses that $m^2 \equiv 5 \pmod 7$ has no solution. Except when $D = 10$,

$$\frac{\varphi(2D)}{\sqrt{D}} \geq \frac{12}{\sqrt{13}}. \tag{46}$$

Indeed for odd D the left side is the product of $(p-1)/\sqrt{p}$ over its prime factors. A single prime must be at least 13, and two distinct primes contribute at least $40/\sqrt{55} > 12/\sqrt{13}$; all further factors exceed one. For even D there is an additional factor $\sqrt{2}$. A single odd prime is 5 (the exceptional $D = 10$) or at least 11, and two odd primes again give a larger product. Apply [12, Theorem 1.3] to two copies of the root multiset in (44), to remove any half-integral coefficients. Together with (46) this gives

$$4m^2 + 2 \geq \frac{mt}{2}\varphi(2D) \geq \frac{6m\sqrt{9m^2+4}}{\sqrt{13}}.$$

For $m > 1$ this is impossible, since

$$36m^2(9m^2+4) - 13(4m^2+2)^2 = 4(m^2-1)(29m^2+13) > 0.$$

The exceptional squareclass requires the following equality statement.

Lemma 8.11 (The conductor-forty bound)**.** *If a multiset of N roots of unity has sum $-a - b\sqrt{10}$, where $a, b \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$, then $N \geq a + 8b$. If equality holds and the sum of the squared roots lies in $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{10})$, that second sum is a.*

Proof. Choose a cyclotomic field containing all roots and $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{10})$. Take the union of the multiset over its Galois group G fixing $\sqrt{10}$, and put $M = |G|$. This gives a multiset of MN roots, with sum $-Ma - Mb\sqrt{10}$, whose multiplicities are constant on G-orbits. Multiplicities remain integral throughout.

If an orbit consists of primitive nth roots and $40 \nmid n$, its sum is the Ramanujan sum $\mu(n) \in \{0, 1, -1\}$ and its size is $\varphi(n)$. Its rational contribution therefore costs at least one root per unit. A negative contribution realizes equality only for the singleton orbit $\{-1\}$.

If $40 \mid n$, the primitive roots split into two equal orbits, distinguished by the primitive quadratic character of conductor 40. Their sums are

$$\frac{\mu(n) \pm \tau_n(\chi_{40})}{2}.$$

Here $\mu(n) = 0$, and the induced Gauss sum vanishes unless $n = 40u$ with u squarefree and coprime to 40. In that case

$$\tau_n(\chi_{40}) = \mu(u)\chi_{40}(u)\sqrt{40}.$$

This formula follows by separating the factors coprime to 40 in the Chinese remainder theorem; an extra power of a prime dividing the conductor gives zero. Thus an orbit contributes zero or $\pm\sqrt{10}$, at cost at least eight roots. Equality for a nonzero contribution requires $n = 40$.

The rational and irrational contributions come from disjoint types of orbit, so $MN \geq Ma + 8Mb$. Equality leaves only Ma copies of $\{-1\}$ and Mb copies of the negative quadratic orbit of primitive fortieth roots. The latter orbit has squared sum zero: reduction of its exponents modulo 20 gives every unit once, since $\chi_{40}(x+20) = -\chi_{40}(x)$, and the resulting sum is $\mu(20) = 0$. The averaged squared sum is therefore Ma. By the additional hypothesis, Galois averaging multiplied the original second sum by M. Dividing by M gives the assertion. □

In our application m, t are even and $a = m^2/2$, $b = mt/2$. Lemma 8.11 gives

$$4m^2 + 2 \geq \frac{m^2}{2} + 4mt$$

For $m \geq 4$ one has $t/m > \sqrt{9/10} > 15/16$, making the right side strictly larger than $17m^2/4 > 4m^2 + 2$. The remaining $m = t = 2$ is the equality case, so the squared sum must be 2, whereas (45) gives -2 or $-2 - 4\sqrt{10}$. Thus $m = 1$. The same argument, including the indispensable second-moment hypothesis, is recorded in `hi_cft_20260923_next_structure_rank6_indicators.md` and `hi_cft_20260923_next_rank6_root_audit.md`.

Consequently

$$d = \frac{3+\sqrt{13}}{2}, \qquad s = \frac{13+3\sqrt{13}}{2}, \qquad d_X = \frac{11+3\sqrt{13}}{2}. \tag{47}$$

Lemma 8.12 (The six residual twists)**.** *For $m = 1$, there are six residual central simples, each with $n_j = 1$. Their twists are the six primitive thirteenth roots with quadratic nonresidue exponents, and $\nu_2(\rho) = 1$.*

Proof. Equation (44) gives a multiset of six roots with sum $(-1-\sqrt{13})/2$. Average it over a cyclotomic Galois group fixing $\sqrt{13}$, as in Lemma 8.11. An orbit with nonzero $\sqrt{13}$ coefficient has coefficient of absolute value $1/2$ and at least six members. To see the equality condition, the induced quadratic Gauss-sum formula is nonzero only at primitive orders $13u$, with u squarefree and coprime to 13. The orbit size is $6\varphi(u)$, so equality permits only $u = 1, 2$.

The entire available length is already needed for the irrational coefficient. Hence no rational-only orbit or cancellation can occur. The two possible negative quadratic orbits, of orders 13 and 26, have sums $(-1-\sqrt{13})/2$ and $(1-\sqrt{13})/2$, respectively. The required rational coefficient forces every orbit to be the former. Consequently every original root is one of the six nonresidue thirteenth roots. These six roots are linearly independent over $\mathbb{Q}$: a rational relation would give a polynomial of degree at most twelve, with zero constant term, divisible by $\Phi_{13}(t) = 1 + t + \cdots + t^{12}$, and hence zero. Comparison with the quadratic period shows that each root occurs once. As each object was repeated n_j^2 times, all six objects have $n_j = 1$ and distinct twists.

Multiplication by two sends nonresidues modulo thirteen to residues, so the second sum is $(-1+\sqrt{13})/2$. Equation (45) now gives $\varepsilon = 1$. □

The center thus has twelve simples. Its dimensions and twist exponents are

number	1	1	4	6
dimension	1	d^2	s	$3d$

$$0, 0, 0, 0, \tfrac{1}{3}, \tfrac{2}{3}, \tfrac{2}{13}, \tfrac{5}{13}, \tfrac{6}{13}, \tfrac{7}{13}, \tfrac{8}{13}, \tfrac{11}{13}.$$

The complete S, T data follow from [20, Theorem A(2), equivalently Theorem 5.1]: this statement assumes a complex spherical untwisted HI category. The auxiliary metric group has prime order 13 and its negative quadratic Gauss sum fixes its isometry class. This identifies the standard Haagerup modular data. It does not by itself identify a braided category; that stronger conclusion is treated separately below and in the analytic section.

8.5 An optional algebraic classification route

There is a second possible route from this fusion ring to an abstract ribbon identification. We isolate its extra input rather than folding an unreplayed classification into the preceding modular-data argument. Vercleyen [36, Section 4.4 and Table 9.1, p. 171] reports an exhaustive classification of complex pivotal multiplicity-free fusion categories of rank at most seven. Its list for $\mathrm{HI}(\mathbb{Z}_3)$ has four entries. Gauge equivalence there permits complex nonzero scalars and ring automorphisms; no unitarity assumption is imposed. The solution method uses exact polynomial and algebraic-number operations, with a separate numerical redundancy check. The complete notebooks and decision logs are available on request rather than included in the thesis [36, Sections 4.1.7–4.1.8 and 4.4.1]. We have not independently replayed that exhaustion calculation.

Proposition 8.13 (Ribbon identification with an additional classification input)**.** *Assume, in addition to the hypotheses used above, that the four-entry list in [36, Table 9.1] exhausts complex pivotal fusion categories with the* $\mathrm{HI}(\mathbb{Z}_3)$ *fusion ring. Then* $\mathcal{F}$ *is tensor equivalent to* $\mathcal{H}_2$ *or* $\mathcal{H}_3$*, and there is an abstract ribbon equivalence*

$$\mathrm{Rep}(U) \simeq Z(\mathcal{H}_3).$$

In particular this modular category is abstractly unitarizable.

Proof. Evans–Gannon [37, Theorem 3(ii)] construct four inequivalent pivotal categories with this ring. Two have noninvertible dimension $(3+\sqrt{13})/2$ and are the unitary categories $\mathcal{H}_2$ and $\mathcal{H}_3$; the other two have dimension $(3-\sqrt{13})/2$. Their theorem classifies the endomorphism realizations considered there; the additional exhaustion hypothesis is what makes this a complete list for the present abstract $\mathcal{F}$.

A pivotal structure on any categorification of this ring is unique when it exists. Indeed, the ratio of two such structures is a tensor automorphism of the identity. Write its scalar on a simple Z as t_Z. Since ρ^2 contains both $\mathbf{1}$ and ρ, $t_\rho^2 = 1 = t_\rho$. It also contains $a\rho$ and $a^2\rho$, so their scalars are one, and $a \otimes \rho = a\rho$ gives $t_a = 1$. Thus all six scalars are one. The negative-dimensional examples cannot acquire a positive spherical structure by repivotalization. The positive spherical category $\mathcal{F}$ is therefore one of the two positive examples.

The categories $\mathcal{H}_2$ and $\mathcal{H}_3$ are Morita equivalent by [29, Theorem 1.4], so their centers are braided equivalent. Combining this with $\mathrm{Rep}(U) \simeq Z(\mathcal{F})$ gives the claimed braided equivalence. Both sides have the positive spherical structures, which are unique; the induced pivotal and twist structures are consequently preserved. This makes the equivalence ribbon. Transporting the unitary structure from the Haagerup center proves abstract unitarizability. □

This proposition does not establish positivity of the canonical VOA fusion pairings or the analytic realization of the transported adjoint. Those are separate complete-unitarity assertions addressed later. Neither this classification input nor the proposition is needed for the character computation that follows.

9 The complete character vector

Let $q = e^{2\pi i\tau}$. Character exponents are $h - c/24 = h - 1/3$. Using the preceding twist list and strict positivity of nonvacuum lowest weights, the only allowed nonvacuum pole is $\gamma q^{-7/39}$ in the twist-$2/13$ coordinate. Here $\gamma \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$ is its top dimension if that module starts at $2/13$, and is zero if its lowest weight is shifted upward. The vacuum pole is $q^{-1/3}$ with coefficient one.

Lemma 9.1 (Uniqueness from the principal part)**.** *Two character vectors for this modular representation with the same γ coincide in every weight.*

Proof. The modular representation has finite image by the congruence theorem [16, Theorem I]. A constant vector must be fixed by both S and the *character* T matrix, which includes $e^{-2\pi i/3}$. The only T-fixed coordinate is the object of categorical twist $e^{2\pi i/3}$. Its S image has a nonzero vacuum component, so it cannot span an invariant line. There are therefore no invariant constants, and Lemma 8.7 applies. □

Evans–Gannon [2, Sections 1.4 and 2.4, equation (2.7)] provide a fundamental matrix Ξ whose vacuum and d_3 columns have precisely the two principal parts above. Thus, in their labeling,

$$\boldsymbol{\chi} = \Xi_{:,0} + \gamma \Xi_{:,d_3}, \qquad \dim U_1 = 6 + 13\gamma.$$

The actual six-current result forces $\gamma = 0$. Their recursive construction of Ξ and the uniqueness lemma give the entire vector, not just a finite coefficient match. In particular,

$$\operatorname{ch} U = q^{-1/3}(1 + 6q + 120q^2 + 956q^3 + 6010q^4 + \cdots). \tag{48}$$

The lowest weights and top dimensions are

label	h	$\dim M_{\mathrm{top}}$	label	h	$\dim M_{\mathrm{top}}$
0	0	1	d_1	6/13	7
b	1	80	d_2	11/13	42
a	1	81	d_3	15/13	119
c_0	1	81	d_4	5/13	5
c_1	1/3	3	d_5	7/13	13
c_2	2/3	27	d_6	8/13	14

In particular the final maximum is $15/13$, improving the preliminary $17/10$ bound. The proof record is `hi_cft_20260923_next_structure_conditional_characters.md`. Although this vector fixes every unflavoured homogeneous dimension, it does not determine the separate branching functions for the fourteen-module core A_L, and it was not used to prove properness.

Corollary 9.2 (The four unmixed lattice restrictions)**.** *The two lattice modules labelled $(0, \pm 1) \in (\mathbb{Z}/3)^2$ restrict to the simple U-module c_1, and the two labelled $(\pm 1, 0)$ restrict to c_2.*

Proof. The first pair has lowest weight $1/3$, top dimension three, and weights in $1/3 + \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$. The next possible summand top, $4/3$, exceeds the established maximum $15/13$. The character list contains a unique simple of lowest weight $1/3$, with top dimension three, so semisimplicity gives precisely one copy of c_1. The second pair has lowest weight $2/3$, top dimension 27, and next possible top $5/3$; the same argument gives c_2. No additional finite-top irreducibility calculation is required. □

10 From vacuum unitarity to complete unitarity

The exact strong-generation certificates concern the actual subVOA $U \subset B \subset H = V_{E_8}$. In particular, they establish $\dim U_1 = 6$ and $U \neq B$; they do not establish positivity on all modules or on fusion products. We now separate those questions. *Vacuum unitarity* is the positive invariant form inherited by the PCT-stable subVOA U. *Strong unitarity* means that all simple ordinary U-modules admit compatible positive invariant forms. *Complete unitarity* additionally includes positivity of the canonical Hermitian fusion forms, giving the VOA representation category its unitary modular tensor structure. An abstract ribbon equivalence to a unitary category does not, by itself, prove this last positivity statement.

We use the preceding algebraic analysis as input: regularity of U, the actual restrictions

$$B{\downarrow_U} = U \oplus X, \qquad H{\downarrow_U} = U \oplus X \oplus Y^{\oplus 2}, \qquad h_X = h_Y = 1, \tag{49}$$

the twelve simple algebraic U-modules, and the $\mathrm{HI}(\mathbb{Z}/3)$ fusion ring of the all-module category for the original extension. Every use of these inputs inherits the qualifications attached to their preceding proofs. Agreement of modular data alone is never used as a classification of tensor categories.

HIGH PRIORITY REVIEW — Analytic proof boundary

We distinguish two comparisons. The linear reconstruction of modules and the independent sector count are proved below from the stated algebraic inputs and external reconstruction theorems. These resolve the earlier obligations A3 and A2, respectively. The remaining obligation A1 identifies the particular bounded annulus insertions used in the positivity theorem. It is stronger than a linear equivalence of module categories. Complete unitarity, the unitary ribbon identification for the VOA, and the specifically $\mathcal{H}_3$ VOA extension retain this explicit hypothesis. The net category itself is identified unitarily without A1. The arguments below are mathematical deductions for review, not an assertion of independent expert validation.

10.1 The subnet and its sector count

There are two net constructions in use. Write $\mathcal{N}_V$ for the net generated by the closed smeared fields of a strongly local VOA V, and temporarily write $\mathcal{A}_V^{\mathrm{bl}}$ for the net generated by Tener's bounded localized insertions. For $V = U, B, H$ both exist: strong locality passes to unitary subalgebras, as do bounded localized vertex operators. The conformal vectors are the ambient ones, so the rotations and central charge agree in each construction.

First work with the bounded-insertion inclusion. Regularity of U and Tener [22, Corollary 4.24] give

$$[\mathcal{A}_H^{\mathrm{bl}} : \mathcal{A}_U^{\mathrm{bl}}] < \infty.$$

The ambient net is the holomorphic lattice net, by Tener [21, Proposition 7.5]. Hence Longo [25, Theorem 24] makes $\mathcal{A}_U^{\mathrm{bl}}$ completely rational. Tener's Lemma 7.6 gives a vacuum net isomorphism $\mathcal{A}_U^{\mathrm{bl}} \cong \mathcal{N}_U$, using the ambient lattice comparison. It follows that $\mathcal{N}_U$ is completely rational as well. Only this isomorphism-invariant property is transferred here: we do not infer equality of the two concrete net constructions or an identification of their embedded extensions. In particular, this step does not assume strong unitarity of U.

The actual smeared-field inclusion $\mathcal{N}_U \subset \mathcal{N}_H$ will be used for the sector calculation. Its branching and index are established below, after the elementary domain lemma needed for reconstruction.

Proposition 10.1 (The actual net branching and sector count; A2)**.** *Assume the algebraic branching and rank-six ring deductions of Section 8, including their certificate hypotheses. The restriction of the holomorphic H net has precisely the three inequivalent irreducible $\mathcal{N}_U$ summands corresponding to (49), with multiplicities $1, 1, 2$. Its boundary fusion category $\mathcal{F}_{\mathrm{net}}$ has rank six, untwisted invertible subcategory $\mathrm{Vec}_{\mathbb{Z}/3}$, and the $\mathrm{HI}(\mathbb{Z}/3)$ fusion ring. Consequently*

$$\mathrm{Rep}(\mathcal{N}_U) \simeq Z(\mathcal{F}_{\mathrm{net}}), \qquad \#\,\mathrm{Irr}\,\mathrm{Rep}(\mathcal{N}_U) = 12.$$

Proof. Every field $v \in U$ satisfies polynomial energy bounds on H, since it is a field of the strongly local lattice VOA and the conformal Hamiltonian is unchanged. Its restriction to an algebraic unitary summand satisfies the same bound. Consequently the finite-energy spaces are cores for the smeared fields in the respective Hilbert completions. Apply Lemma 10.2 below to the orthogonal summand projections. This proves that the algebraic decomposition of H is a Hilbert direct-sum decomposition for the actual represented subnet. Conversely, a subnet intertwiner commutes with its local diffeomorphisms and hence with L_0. The equality of closed fields in reconstruction, or Fourier coefficients of their matrix elements, then makes its finite-energy restriction a U-module map. Thus simple summands stay irreducible and inequivalent, and the multiplicities remain $1, 1, 2$.

The inclusion is irreducible. To see the local assertion explicitly, let $x \in \mathcal{N}_H(I) \cap \mathcal{N}_U(I)'$. Locality makes x commute with $\mathcal{N}_U(I')$ as well. Strong additivity of $\mathcal{N}_U$ shows that the algebras of I and its complementary interval generate the global represented subnet: remove the two endpoints from any test interval and apply strong additivity twice. Thus x commutes with the global subnet and, in particular, its local diffeomorphisms and common rotations. Its action on the vacuum lies in the one-dimensional zero-energy space of H, so the separating property of the vacuum makes it scalar. The precise finite-index input is now Kawahigashi–Longo [26, Proposition 2.3]: an irreducible local extension of a net with finitely many irreducible DHR sectors, and in which every sector is a direct sum of finite-statistical-dimension sectors, has finite index. These hypotheses follow from the complete rationality already established for $\mathcal{N}_U$. Thus the actual inclusion has finite index. Its dual canonical sector is the restriction of the H vacuum computed above, and its dimension is the inclusion index. Its algebra A_{net} is Lagrangian because $\mathcal{N}_H$ is holomorphic. The preceding comparison also gives the algebra identity

$$\mathrm{End}(A_{\mathrm{net}}) \cong \mathbb{C} \oplus \mathbb{C} \oplus M_2(\mathbb{C}). \tag{50}$$

Here the multiplication is composition, rather than a dimension count alone. Center induction identifies its dimension with $\mathrm{rank}(\mathcal{F}_{\mathrm{net}})$, and identifies the algebra with the complex fusion algebra of $\mathcal{F}_{\mathrm{net}}$. Thus the latter has rank six and is noncommutative.

We next identify the invertible objects using only the actual $\mathbb{Z}/3$ lattice-extension automorphisms of H/B. They act on the net inclusion and hence on its canonical algebra. The automorphism–invertible-object injection of Lemma 8.1 embeds this group in $\mathrm{Inv}(\mathcal{F}_{\mathrm{net}})$. Since the category has rank six, the latter group has order three or six. If its order were six, the category would be pointed of global dimension six. The intermediate lattice inclusion has $[\mathcal{N}_H : \mathcal{N}_B] = 3$, so multiplicativity of index would give $[\mathcal{N}_B : \mathcal{N}_U] = 2$. An irreducible local index-two extension is the fixed-point extension of its sign involution: its canonical algebra is $\mathbf{1} \oplus \beta$, where $\beta^2 = \mathbf{1}$, and $\mathbf{1} \oplus (-\mathrm{id}_\beta)$ is its nontrivial algebra automorphism. Theorem 6.9 of [3] lifts this vacuum-preserving net automorphism to a unitary automorphism g of the actual B. Their Proposition 7.6 gives $\mathcal{N}_{B^g} = \mathcal{N}_B^g = \mathcal{N}_U$, and injectivity of their unitary-subalgebra/subnet correspondence (Theorem 7.5) gives $B^g = U$. This contradicts Lemma 8.2. Consequently

$$\mathrm{Inv}(\mathcal{F}_{\mathrm{net}}) \cong \mathbb{Z}/3.$$

This argument needs no assertion about the full pointwise stabilizer $\mathrm{Aut}(B/U)$.

The lattice net $\mathcal{N}_B$ has discriminant metric group $\mathbb{Z}/3 \times \mathbb{Z}/3$ with $q(a,b) = (2a^2 + b^2)/3 \pmod{\mathbb{Z}}$. The extension H/B is its diagonal isotropic line $L_+ = \{(a,a)\}$, and $L_- = \{(a,-a)\}$ is a transverse isotropic line. The subcategory $\mathcal{T}_-$ supported on L_- is Tannakian and is tensor equivalent to the untwisted $\mathrm{Vec}_{\mathbb{Z}/3}$. Let Q_+ be the extension algebra supported on L_+. Free-module induction $t \mapsto t \otimes Q_+$ is a tensor functor from $\mathcal{T}_-$ to the category of all Q_+-modules. For simple $t, t' \in \mathcal{T}_-$, its adjunction gives

$$\mathrm{Hom}_{Q_+}(t \otimes Q_+, t' \otimes Q_+) \cong \mathrm{Hom}(t, t' \otimes Q_+) = \begin{cases} \mathbb{C}, & t = t', \\ 0, & t \neq t'. \end{cases}$$

Here transversality $L_+ \cap L_- = \{0\}$ gives the last equality. The target has dimension $9/3 = 3$, so these three distinct invertible images exhaust its simple objects. Induction is therefore a tensor equivalence. Forgetting the intermediate B-action embeds this category fully faithfully and tensorially in $\mathcal{F}_{\mathrm{net}}$; relative tensor product over the same H algebra is unchanged. Thus the entire pointed subcategory is untwisted.

We may now apply the rank-six ring and indicator argument of Section 8 to $\mathcal{F}_{\mathrm{net}}$ itself. Its hypotheses are the fusion-algebra decomposition above, the three invertibles, and their untwisted associator. They have just been proved for this category, and its spherical structure is positive because it is a C^* fusion category. The argument gives (43) with multiplicity one. In particular, for $d = (3 + \sqrt{13})/2$ and $s = 1 + d^2$, the center calculation gives dimensions

$$1,\ d^2,\ \underbrace{s, s, s, s}_{4},\ \underbrace{3d, 3d, 3d, 3d, 3d, 3d}_{6}. \tag{51}$$

The same center-induction and indicator calculation gives the last six twists with exponents $\{2, 5, 6, 7, 8, 11\}/13$. This is the source of the net count twelve. Finally the Lagrangian-algebra theorem gives $\mathrm{Rep}(\mathcal{N}_U) \simeq Z(\mathcal{F}_{\mathrm{net}})$, and the displayed center dimensions give its rank twelve. No VOA character transformation matrix was assigned to the net category. □

For comparison, the first paragraph also follows for the bounded-insertion inclusion directly from Tener [21, Proposition 5.5 and Theorem 5.6]. The argument above has the additional advantage that the later automorphism comparison refers throughout to the original lattice fields. The purely categorical deductions used in the proof are recorded in `hi_cft_20260923_next_structure_rank46.md`, `hi_cft_20260923_next_structure_rank6_indicators.md`, and `hi_cft_20260923_next_structure_rank6_center.md`.

10.2 Reverse reconstruction and exhaustion

Henriques–Tener [23, Theorem 9.5 and Corollary 9.7] reconstruct unitary modules and identify their closed smeared fields. Remark 9.8 extends the construction beyond the finite-multiplicity hypothesis. This extension matters: finite-dimensional energy eigenspaces must not be silently assumed for the net representation one is trying to reconstruct. Their Theorem 8.9 identifies the reconstructed vacuum VOA of $\mathcal{N}_U$ with the original U, since U is strongly local.

The closure step can be isolated from the VOA theory. Its formulation also explains why a formal mode identity alone is insufficient.

Lemma 10.2 (Reduction on a common core)**.** *Let $T_0 : D \to \mathcal{K}$ be a densely defined closable operator and P an orthogonal projection. Suppose $PD \subset D$ and $T_0 P\xi = PT_0\xi$ for $\xi \in D$. Then P reduces $T = \overline{T_0}$ and T^*, and it commutes with the von Neumann algebra generated by T. In particular, this holds simultaneously for a family of fields satisfying these hypotheses on a common core.*

Proof. If $\xi_j \in D$ converges to $\xi \in D(T)$ in graph norm, then $P\xi_j \to P\xi$ and $T_0 P\xi_j = PT_0\xi_j \to PT\xi$. Thus $P\xi \in D(T)$ and $TP\xi = PT\xi$. The same assertion holds for $1-P$. It follows that T is the direct sum of its closed restrictions to $P\mathcal{K}$ and $(1-P)\mathcal{K}$; taking adjoints gives the corresponding direct sum for T^*. Its polar partial isometry and the spectral projections of $|T|$ are therefore block diagonal. These generate the von Neumann algebra of T, proving the last assertion. Notice that no separate assertion that D is a core for T^* is required. □

Proposition 10.3 (Reverse module comparison; A3)**.** *For this regular U, reconstruction sends each irreducible $\mathcal{N}_U$ sector to an irreducible ordinary unitary U-module. It preserves L_0 and induces a fully faithful linear $*$-functor on finite direct sums,*

$$\mathcal{R} : \mathrm{Rep}(\mathcal{N}_U) \longrightarrow \mathrm{Rep}^u(U).$$

The functor preserves conformal Hamiltonians. No tensorator or compatibility with braiding is asserted.

Proof. Let $\mathcal{K}$ be an irreducible net representation and put

$$M = \bigcup_{R>0} 1_{[0,R]}(L_0)\mathcal{K}$$

as in Henriques–Tener, Remark 9.8. This is a dense admissible weak U-module with a positive invariant Hermitian form. Theorem 9.5(ii) and its extension in that remark identify the closed reconstructed smeared field with $\pi_I(Y_U(v,f))$ for $\mathrm{supp}(f) \subset I$. By Definition 9.4, M is a core for this closed operator. The proof of Corollary 9.6 applies unchanged on bounded-energy vectors, so the VOA zero mode of the conformal vector is precisely the self-adjoint rotation generator on this domain.

Regularity decomposes the weak module M algebraically into ordinary simple modules. Choose a nonzero simple summand S. Its inherited form is positive and invariant. Since its L_0 is the restriction of the net Hamiltonian, its energy decomposition is

$$S = \bigoplus_{n\geq 0} S_{h+n}, \qquad \dim S_{h+n} < \infty, \quad h \geq 0.$$

The Hilbert closure $\overline{S}$ is the orthogonal Hilbert sum of these finite-dimensional spaces. In particular it reduces L_0, and the projection P onto $\overline{S}$ satisfies

$$P1_{[0,R]}(L_0)\mathcal{K} \subset \bigoplus_{h+n\leq R} S_{h+n} \subset S, \qquad PM \subset S \subset M. \tag{52}$$

This establishes the domain invariance before any commutation with fields is used. It requires finite energy multiplicities only for the chosen ordinary summand, not for $\mathcal{K}$.

For a homogeneous $v \in U$, the unitary invariance identity expresses the adjoint of a mode $v_{(n)}$, on M, as a finite linear combination of modes of the vectors $L_1^j \theta v$, where θ is PCT. Every such mode preserves S. Testing against $s \in S$ therefore gives

$$\langle Pv_{(n)}\xi, s\rangle = \langle \xi, v_{(n)}^\dagger s\rangle = \langle P\xi, v_{(n)}^\dagger s\rangle = \langle v_{(n)}P\xi, s\rangle.$$

Both outer vectors lie in S, by (52), whence $Pv_{(n)}\xi = v_{(n)}P\xi$ for $\xi \in M$. The smeared fields on M are Hilbert-space vectors, as in the paragraph preceding Henriques–Tener Definition 9.4. Taking their energy components, or equivalently their convergent Fourier sums, now yields

$$PY^M(v,f)\xi = Y^M(v,f)P\xi, \qquad \xi \in M.$$

There is no assertion here that a smeared field maps M into itself. Only its value in $\mathcal{K}$ and the boundedness of P are needed. Lemma 10.2 extends this identity to the closures and their adjoints.

The local algebras are generated by the closed smeared fields. Normal representations preserve this generation statement (equivalently, apply them to the polar decompositions and spectral projections). Thus P is a net intertwiner. Irreducibility and $S \neq 0$ imply $P = 1$. Equation (52) then implies $M = S$. This proves ordinaryness and simplicity, including the removal of the infinite multiplicities permitted in Remark 9.8.

Finally consider morphisms. A net intertwiner commutes with the canonical diffeomorphism action, because that action is generated by the local diffeomorphism groups. It therefore preserves bounded-energy vectors. Commutation with the reconstructed fields gives commutation with their Fourier coefficients, hence a module map. Conversely, an isomorphism of simple ordinary unitary modules is a scalar multiple of a unitary. To verify this without presupposing boundedness, compare the two invariant forms on each finite-dimensional energy space. The resulting grade-preserving positive operator is an algebraic U-endomorphism, by invariance of the forms. An eigenvector in the finite-dimensional lowest space has an eigenspace that is a nonzero U-submodule. Simplicity makes that eigenspace the whole module, so the comparison operator is a single positive scalar on all grades. The isomorphism therefore has a bounded unitary rescaling. Its unitary extension intertwines the smeared fields on their common cores and hence their closures, so it intertwines the nets. Between inequivalent simples both morphism spaces vanish. Matrices of these maps handle finite direct sums and respect adjoints. This proves full faithfulness and the asserted linear $*$-functor. □

The preliminary version of this deduction is recorded in `hi_cft_20260923_next_m3_unitarity_scope.md`.

Proposition 10.4 (Strong unitarity from sector exhaustion)**.** *Under the preceding algebraic inputs, including the count of twelve simple U-modules, every simple U-module is unitarizable, and its character is the character of a net sector.*

Proof. Full faithfulness makes the twelve net simples pairwise inequivalent simple ordinary U-modules. There are exactly twelve algebraic simple modules, so this injection is a bijection. Each image carries its reconstructed positive form, and L_0 is preserved. Finite direct sums give the corresponding statement for ordinary modules. □

This counting step supplies essential surjectivity only as a linear comparison. Neither fusion compatibility, equality of categorical S matrices, nor positivity of VOA fusion forms follows from it.

10.3 The annulus compatibility claim

The next step concerns the specific geometric annulus system of Tener [21, Definition 3.18 and Corollaries 3.20–3.22]. Let (B, A) be a localized pair for an interval I, with incoming factor A and outgoing factor B. Subscripts distinguish their actions on the vacuum and on a reconstructed module. For an insertion point $z \in \operatorname{int}(B, A)$, put

$$X_v(B, z, A) = \overline{B_U Y_U(v, z) A_U} \in \mathcal{A}_U^{\mathrm{bl}}(I).$$

Here the bar denotes the bounded operator represented by the sesquilinear insertion form. At a point outside the incoming annulus one must not silently treat the unsmeared formal field as an everywhere defined Hilbert-space operator. The earlier abstract isomorphism $\mathcal{A}_U^{\mathrm{bl}} \cong \mathcal{N}_U$ does

not identify these operators. The following claim includes the specific vacuum identification needed to compare them, and then its module version.

HIGH PRIORITY REVIEW — A1: new annulus compatibility lemma

Claim 10.5 (Annulus compatibility; unproved geometric comparison)**.** *For the actual geometric system above, choose matching paths and central lifts in the two annulus constructions. In the vacuum, the geometric insertion of Henriques–Tener is $X_v(B,z,A)$ and identifies $\mathcal{A}_U^{\mathrm{bl}}$ with $\mathcal{N}_U$ on the original vacuum Hilbert space. If M is an ordinary unitary module reconstructed from a sector π_M, then*

$$\pi_M\big(X_v(B,z,A)\big) = \overline{B_M Y_M(v,z) A_M}, \qquad v \in U, \quad z \in \mathrm{int}(B,A). \tag{53}$$

The right side exists as a bounded extension of the insertion form.

The remaining point requiring verification is a comparison of the specific geometric annulus systems and their central lifts, including their localizing diffeomorphisms. The domain-density and continuation steps are proved in the lemmas below. They do not require the inverse-finite-energy domains to be graph cores. Agreement after an unspecified vacuum net isomorphism would not prove the displayed operator identity.

The unresolved comparison has a concrete formulation. For a geometric incoming annulus $X = (\psi, \rho, t, \gamma)$ in Tener's Definition 3.16, his vacuum operator is

$$U(\psi) e^{-tL(\rho)} U(\gamma)^*.$$

One must select the corresponding centrally extended annulus $\underline{X}$, with the same embedded inner boundary and boundary parametrizations, and identify this expression with its integrated action. The time-ordered integration in Henriques–Tener [24, Theorem 5.5 and formula (5.2)] gives the candidate: constant generators integrate to exponentials, and thin factors to the diffeomorphism action. The comparison must retain the central scalar and use the same path lifts. A lift normalized only by its action on the vacuum need not have the same action in a sector of fractional lowest weight.

More precisely, choose the common localizing diffeomorphism $\widehat{\gamma}$ of Tener's Corollary 3.20. The required geometric statement is that $\widehat{\gamma}\underline{X}$ is the corresponding localized centrally extended annulus, with its specified lift, and that its vacuum action is the local Virasoro operator $U(\widehat{\gamma})\pi(X)$. Once this statement is known, Henriques–Tener Proposition 4.17 transports it to every sector: both constructions act there by

$$U^M(\widehat{\gamma})^* \pi_I^M\big(U(\widehat{\gamma})\pi(X)\big).$$

The same localizing lift must be used for the incoming and outgoing members of a pair. This is the precise normalization problem retained in A1; scalar equality in just one representation is insufficient.

Lemma 10.6 (Dense inverse-energy domains)**.** *Let M be an ordinary unitary module and let A_M, C_M be the actions of geometric annuli on its Hilbert completion. Suppose*

$$A_M C_M = \lambda r^{L_0}, \qquad 0 < r < 1, \quad \lambda \neq 0. \tag{54}$$

Then $A_M^{-1} M^{\mathrm{fin}} = C_M M^{\mathrm{fin}}$ is dense. The same conclusion holds for the outgoing adjoint factor.

Proof. The geometric annulus actions are injective and have dense range by Henriques–Tener Lemma 4.15. Equation (54) first gives $C_M M^{\mathrm{fin}} \subset A_M^{-1} M^{\mathrm{fin}}$. Conversely, if $A_M\xi \in M^{\mathrm{fin}}$, then

$$A_M\xi = A_M C_M \lambda^{-1} r^{-L_0} A_M \xi, \qquad \xi = C_M \lambda^{-1} r^{-L_0} A_M \xi.$$

The last equality uses injectivity of A_M, and proves the reverse inclusion. Finally M^{fin} is dense and C_M is bounded with dense range; hence $C_M M^{\mathrm{fin}}$ is dense. This is the argument of Henriques–Tener Lemma 7.9 with a central scalar retained. □

For the geometric annuli under consideration the factorization itself is elementary. The incoming annulus is embedded in the unit disc, its smooth inner Jordan domain contains zero, and its outer parametrization is the identity. Choose a sufficiently small round disc $r\mathbb{D}$ inside that inner domain. The intervening annulus C has its outer parametrization chosen to sew to the inner boundary of A, and its inner parametrization is the standard round one. Then AC is the round annulus. Choosing compatible lifts gives (54). This proves density after the annulus-action identification specified above; density is not an additional unknown analytic assumption.

Define

$$\mathcal{D}_A = \{\xi \in \mathcal{K}_M : A_M\xi \in M^{\mathrm{fin}}\}, \qquad \mathcal{D}_{B^*} = \{\eta \in \mathcal{K}_M : B_M^*\eta \in M^{\mathrm{fin}}\}. \tag{55}$$

Both domains are dense by Lemma 10.6.

Lemma 10.7 (Continuation of the insertion form)**.** *Let O_{in} and O_{out} be the incoming and outgoing insertion interiors, and put*

$$\Omega = \mathrm{int}(\overline{O_{\mathrm{in}}} \cup \overline{O_{\mathrm{out}}}).$$

Suppose a bounded geometric insertion $G_v(z)$ is holomorphic on Ω. If its matrix elements equal the algebraic insertion form on $O_{\mathrm{in}} \cup O_{\mathrm{out}}$, for vectors in the two domains (55), the equality holds throughout Ω. It uniquely defines a bounded extension of that form.

Proof. For $\xi \in \mathcal{D}_A$ and $\eta \in \mathcal{D}_{B^*}$, consider

$$\langle Y_M(v,z) A_M\xi, B_M^*\eta\rangle \tag{56}$$

as a formal matrix coefficient. It is a finite Laurent polynomial: if v has weight k, and the input and output energies are p, q, only the mode with $q = p + k - n - 1$ can contribute. Both vectors have finite energy support. Thus the form and the geometric matrix coefficient are holomorphic on $\Omega \subset \mathbb{C}^\times$.

Every component of Ω meets $O_{\mathrm{in}} \cup O_{\mathrm{out}}$. Indeed, its complement inside Ω is contained in the union of the two boundaries; boundaries of open sets are closed with empty interior, and a finite union of such sets contains no nonempty open component. The identity theorem therefore extends the equality across every component, including any part of the sewing circle lying in Ω. For fixed z, the form is now the restriction of the bounded operator $G_v(z)$ to two dense test domains. This proves existence and uniqueness of its bounded extension. A graph-core assertion is neither used nor needed. □

After the geometric normalization in A1, Henriques–Tener Theorem 9.5(i) supplies the incoming equality. Sewing is the multiplicative action constructed in their Section 6.2; the $*$-compatibility of Proposition 6.19 supplies the outgoing equality. Lemma 10.7 then proves the full identity (53). Thus the operator-domain and continuation parts of the earlier proposed proof have been resolved. The remaining issue is the specified comparison of the two geometric operator constructions, not an implication from strong unitarity alone.

Theorem 10.8 (Conditional complete unitarity)**.** *Assume Claim 10.5, together with the preceding algebraic inputs. Then U is completely unitary.*

Proof. Proposition 10.4 unitarizes every simple module. Claim 10.5 supplies the representation required by Tener [22, Definition 2.18], for each such module; finite direct sums preserve the property. His Corollary 4.6 then supplies positivity of the canonical fusion forms. Strong unitarity must be established first: the unitarizable-fusion-product hypothesis in Theorem 4.4 cannot be used to bypass the exhaustion argument. □

Recent comparison results leave this specific hypothesis in place. Gui's extension comparison assumes Condition II, including complete unitarity and energy bounds and strong intertwining for a generating family of charged fields; his inheritance theorem concerns regular cosets [42, Definition 4.15 and Theorems 4.20, 6.11]. It does not give inheritance by the present conformal subalgebra: the commutant of U in H is the vacuum VOA and its double commutant is H. Henriques–Tener construct bounded vacuum multidisc operators and prove the vacuum trace-class condition [43, Theorems 3.6 and 4.1]; these statements do not identify the module insertion operators in (53). A sufficient remaining target is to match Tener's incoming and outgoing geometric annuli with the integrated annuli, retaining their embedded boundaries, boundary parametrizations, common localizing diffeomorphism, and central path lifts, and then to identify their vacuum point insertions. Sector transport, the dense inverse-energy domains, and continuation proved above would then give A1. A linear equivalence of unitary module categories alone supplies neither this comparison nor the positivity of the canonical VOA fusion forms.

11 Unitary categorical identifications

Lemma 11.1 (All modules over a commutative Q-system)**.** *Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a unitary braided fusion category and A a connected commutative Q-system in $\mathcal{C}$. The category $\mathcal{C}_A$ of all right A-modules, with relative tensor product, is a unitarizable fusion category. This assertion does not require the modules to be local.*

Proof. If $r : M \otimes A \to M$ is a right action, the braiding gives a left action $l = r \circ c_{A,M}$. Commutativity of A and the hexagon identity make these commuting actions, and hence an A-bimodule. Naturality of the braiding makes every right-module morphism a bimodule morphism for these choices. This realizes $\mathcal{C}_A$ as the full subcategory of bimodules with $l = r \circ c_{A,M}$. The relative tensor product is obtained by splitting the separability idempotent on $M \otimes N$. Its induced left and right actions again satisfy this relation, by the same hexagon identity and the balancing relation. Thus the subcategory is closed under relative tensor products, sums and summands, and its unit is A.

Every such bimodule is unitarizable by Gui [27, Theorem 2.28]; an isomorphism transporting the actions preserves the displayed relation. The unitary relative tensor product and its associativity and unit constraints are supplied by Gui, Theorem 3.13. The above full subcategory therefore inherits a C^* tensor structure. Separability gives semisimplicity, connectedness makes its unit simple, and the usual module-category construction over a connected separable algebra gives rigidity and finiteness. It is consequently a unitary fusion category up to tensor equivalence.

For clarity, locality is the additional monodromy condition $r \circ c_{A,M} \circ c_{M,A} = r$. We have not imposed it. Only the local subcategory inherits the ambient braiding by descent. □

Theorem 11.2 (Unitary Haagerup-center identification, conditional on A1)**.** *Under the hypotheses of Theorem 10.8, and the preceding determination of the all-module fusion ring and its untwisted pointed subcategory, there is a unitary ribbon equivalence*

$$\mathrm{Rep}(U) \simeq Z(\mathcal{H}_3).$$

For the original embedded extension H/U, its all-module category is tensor equivalent to one of $\mathcal{H}_2$ and $\mathcal{H}_3$.

Proof. Put $\mathcal{C} = \mathrm{Rep}(U)$ and let A be the algebra of the actual unitary extension H. Complete unitarity allows application of Gui [27, Theorems 2.21 and 2.28]: A is a standard commutative Q-system and its modules are unitarizable. Lemma 11.1 makes $\mathcal{F} = \mathcal{C}_A$ a C^* fusion category. Here $\mathcal{C}_A$ means *all* modules. The local modules form $\mathcal{C}_A^0 \simeq \mathrm{Vec}$ because the extension is holomorphic, so substituting local modules would lose the Haagerup category.

Its already determined fusion ring is $\mathrm{HI}(\mathbb{Z}/3)$. The actual untwisted pointed subcategory makes the obstruction $c^{(0,3)}$ vanish, while the other obstruction is in

$$H^1\Big(\mathbb{Z}/2, H^2(\mathbb{Z}/3, \mathbb{C}^\times)\Big) = 0.$$

Indeed, the cyclic-group calculation gives $H^2(\mathbb{Z}/3, \mathbb{C}^\times) = \mathbb{C}^\times/(\mathbb{C}^\times)^3 = 0$; every nonzero complex number has a cube root. Also $(\mathbb{Z}/3)/2(\mathbb{Z}/3) = 0$, so no choice of distinguished noninvertible object introduces an additional classification orbit. These are the hypotheses in Izumi [28, Definition 2.7 and Theorems 5.9 and 9.1], giving the two unitary tensor classes $\mathcal{H}_2, \mathcal{H}_3$. No algebra structure on $1+\rho$ is inserted as an extra assumption. Grossman–Snyder [29, Theorem 1.4] place these categories in the same Morita class. Their centers are therefore braided equivalent. The positive spherical structures make this a ribbon equivalence, and the Lagrangian-center theorem gives

$$\mathcal{C} \simeq Z(\mathcal{F}) \simeq Z(\mathcal{H}_3).$$

Reutter [30, Theorem 5] provides the unitary braided realization of the equivalence, preserving the associated positive ribbon structures. □

This uses the published unitary classification as an external input; its classification equations have not been replayed here. It avoids the broader pivotal census, but it does not prove that the natural reconstruction functor $\mathcal{R}$ preserves Connes fusion, the VOA tensor product, or braiding. That particular comparison is a distinct statement and is not needed for the theorem just proved conditionally.

Corollary 11.3 (Haagerup-center identification for the conformal net)**.** *Under the preceding algebraic inputs, the completely rational central-charge-eight net $\mathcal{N}_U$ satisfies*

$$\mathrm{Rep}(\mathcal{N}_U) \simeq Z(\mathcal{H}_3)$$

as a unitary ribbon category. Its actual extension to the E_8 lattice net has boundary category equivalent to $\mathcal{H}_2$ or $\mathcal{H}_3$. Neither conclusion requires Claim 10.5.

Proof. Proposition 10.1 constructs $\mathcal{F}_{\mathrm{net}}$ as a unitary fusion category with the $\mathrm{HI}(\mathbb{Z}/3)$ fusion ring and an untwisted pointed subcategory. The Izumi classification and the vanishing obstruction groups used in the preceding proof therefore apply directly to this category. Thus $\mathcal{F}_{\mathrm{net}}$ is tensor equivalent to $\mathcal{H}_2$ or $\mathcal{H}_3$. Their Morita equivalence, the unitary Lagrangian-center theorem, and uniqueness of the unitary braided structure give $\mathrm{Rep}(\mathcal{N}_U) \simeq Z(\mathcal{F}_{\mathrm{net}}) \simeq Z(\mathcal{H}_3)$. No positivity statement about VOA intertwining-operator spaces is used in this argument. □

12 Full net theory and a conditional E_8 VOA extension

Corollary 12.1 (A chosen holomorphic net extension)**.** *Under the preceding algebraic inputs, there is an irreducible local conformal-net extension $\mathcal{N}_U \subset \mathcal{E}_3$ of central charge eight. It is holomorphic and has index*

$$[\mathcal{E}_3 : \mathcal{N}_U] = \mathrm{Dim}(\mathcal{H}_3) = 3(1+d^2), \qquad d = (3+\sqrt{13})/2.$$

Its all-module boundary category is $\mathcal{H}_3$, and its algebra-bimodule category is $\mathcal{H}_3 \boxtimes \mathcal{H}_3^{\mathrm{op}}$, with 36 *simple objects. This construction does not require A1.*

Proof. Transport the canonical connected commutative Q-system $I_{\mathcal{H}_3}(\mathbf{1}) \in Z(\mathcal{H}_3)$ along Corollary 11.3; call the result $Q_3 \in \mathrm{Rep}(\mathcal{N}_U)$. The local-net reconstruction theorem of Longo–Rehren [38, Theorem 4.9] produces the extension. Connectedness is precisely the multiplicity-one hypothesis for the identity sector, hence gives irreducibility. The Q-system has finite statistical dimension, which equals the displayed index; its commutativity is precisely the locality condition in that theorem. The conformal-net form of the correspondence is recalled in [39, Section 2.6]. The represented local diffeomorphism unitaries of the subnet give the conformal action of the extension, so the central charge remains eight.

The finite-index theorem [25, Theorem 24] gives complete rationality. Since Q_3 is Lagrangian, the index relation gives

$$\mu(\mathcal{E}_3) = \frac{\mu(\mathcal{N}_U)}{\dim(Q_3)^2} = 1,$$

and the extension is holomorphic. The canonical-algebra equivalences of [32, Corollary 4.1 and Proposition 4.4] identify the all-module category with $\mathcal{H}_3$. The corresponding bimodule category is $\mathcal{H}_3 \boxtimes \mathcal{H}_3^{\mathrm{op}}$ by the double-centralizer description [35, Sections 4 and 8]; its simple objects are the $6 \cdot 6$ ordered pairs. As below, these algebra-bimodule defects preserve the original $\mathcal{N}_U$ subnet. □

No identification of $\mathcal{E}_3$ with the E_8 lattice net is made here. Holomorphicity and central charge eight are the conclusions of the cited net theorems; the VOA classification used later does not by itself classify arbitrary holomorphic conformal nets. Nor does the present construction identify a reconstructed VOA extension with the selected tensor category of VOA modules.

Proposition 12.2 (Diagonal full theory)**.** *Under the preceding algebraic inputs, the completely rational net $\mathcal{N}_U$ admits its canonical unitary local diagonal full theory. With the twelve-module character determination, its partition function is*

$$Z_{\mathrm{diag}}(\tau,\bar{\tau}) = \sum_{i=0}^{11} \chi_i(\tau)\overline{\chi_i(\tau)}, \qquad c_L = c_R = 8. \tag{57}$$

Proof. Apply the diagonal Longo–Rehren construction, in the identity-coupling case of Rehren [31, Theorem 1.4, Proposition 1.5, and Corollary 1.6]. Propositions 10.1 and 10.3 identify all sector Hilbert spaces with the twelve ordinary modules and preserve their Hamiltonians. Hence their traces give (57). The annulus compatibility claim is not needed for this net construction or this linear character matching. □

Theorem 12.3 (Chosen $\mathcal{H}_3$ extension and defects; conditional on A1)**.** *Assume the hypotheses of Theorem 11.2 and the preceding strict positivity of all nonvacuum lowest conformal weights.*

There exists a unitary holomorphic conformal extension $H' \supset U$ isomorphic to V_{E_8} whose all-module category is $\mathcal{H}_3$. For its extension algebra $A_3 \in \mathrm{Rep}(U)$,

$$\mathrm{Rep}(U)_{A_3} \simeq \mathcal{H}_3, \qquad {}_{A_3}\mathrm{Rep}(U)_{A_3} \simeq \mathcal{H}_3 \boxtimes \mathcal{H}_3^{\mathrm{op}}. \tag{58}$$

The second category describes algebra-bimodule defects preserving the U chiral subalgebra in the corresponding full extension theory and contains an $\mathcal{H}_3$ fusion subcategory. It has 36 simple objects, labelled by ordered pairs of simple objects of $\mathcal{H}_3$.

Proof. Let $I_{\mathcal{H}_3}$ be the right adjoint of the forgetful functor $Z(\mathcal{H}_3) \to \mathcal{H}_3$. Transport the canonical algebra $I_{\mathcal{H}_3}(\mathbf{1})$ along the unitary ribbon equivalence. By the canonical Lagrangian-algebra construction, as in Davydov–Müger–Nikshych–Ostrik [32, Corollary 4.1 and Proposition 4.4], the resulting A_3 is connected, commutative, separable, and twist-free, with

$$\mathrm{FPdim}(A_3)^2 = \mathrm{FPdim}(\mathrm{Rep}(U)), \qquad \mathrm{Rep}(U)^0_{A_3} \simeq \mathrm{Vec}, \qquad \mathrm{Rep}(U)_{A_3} \simeq \mathcal{H}_3.$$

Trivial twist makes its constituent conformal weights integral. Connectedness and strict positivity away from the vacuum give a one-dimensional weight-zero space. The extension correspondence of Huang–Kirillov–Lepowsky [33, Theorems 3.2–3.6], together with Gui's unitary Q-system theorem, produces a unitary conformal VOA extension H'. Here the transported algebra is a Q-system: the canonical algebra in the unitary center has its standard positive Frobenius structure, and the equivalence is unitary. Thus Gui's theorem is applied to a specified positive algebra structure, rather than to an arbitrary separable algebra without a chosen $*$-structure.

For completeness, the finiteness condition on the extension can be checked at the level of C_2 spaces. Write $H' = \bigoplus_i M_i^{\oplus m_i}$ as a finite sum of ordinary U-modules and set

$$C_2^U(H') = \mathrm{span}\{u_{(-2)}w : u \in U,\ w \in H'\}.$$

The module C_2-cofiniteness theorem of Abe–Buhl–Dong [6, Proposition 5.2] implies $\dim H'/C_2^U(H') < \infty$. Since $C_2^U(H') \subset C_2(H')$, the extension is C_2-cofinite. Complete reducibility for the extension follows from the separable algebra/module correspondence in Huang–Kirillov–Lepowsky, Theorems 3.5–3.6. The unitary invariant form makes the simple extension self-contragredient. Together with the already verified CFT-type grading, these are the strong-rationality hypotheses. The Lagrangian condition gives $\mathrm{Rep}(H') \simeq \mathrm{Rep}(U)^0_{A_3} \simeq \mathrm{Vec}$, so it is holomorphic. Its central charge is eight, so Dong–Mason [34, Theorem 1] identifies H' with V_{E_8}.

For the canonical algebra, the algebra-bimodule duality gives the second equivalence in (58); see Müger [35, Sections 4 and 8]. One way to keep track of the opposite is to view $\mathcal{H}_3$ as a module category over its center. The two commuting actions on it are

$$(x \boxtimes y) \cdot m = x \otimes m \otimes y.$$

Composing two such functors reverses the order of the right factors, which accounts for "op" in the formula. The double-centralizer description identifies these endofunctors with the bimodule category of the canonical algebra. The equivalence transports with A_3. The first-factor embedding $x \mapsto x \boxtimes \mathbf{1}$ is fully faithful and tensor, and supplies the stated $\mathcal{H}_3$ fusion subcategory. There are $6 \cdot 6 = 36$ simple pairs, with dimensions $\dim(x)\dim(y)$. As a consistency check, their total squared dimension is $\mathrm{Dim}(\mathcal{H}_3)^2 = \mathrm{Dim}(\mathrm{Rep}(U))$, as required by Morita duality. □

Remark 12.4 (Extension choice and preserved symmetry)**.** The selection of the canonical $\mathcal{H}_3$ algebra proves existence of H' with the specified all-module category. It does not identify A_3 with the original embedded H/U algebra; the original boundary category may be $\mathcal{H}_2$ or $\mathcal{H}_3$.

Both holomorphic VOAs being isomorphic to V_{E_8} does not identify their embeddings of U. Moreover, the defects in (58) preserve U and need not preserve the enlarged E_8 chiral algebra. The local chiral H'-module category is Vec.

The finite certificates and algebraic arguments supply the stated representation-theory inputs. The proved comparisons A2–A3 then give sector exhaustion, strong unitarity, and a unitary Haagerup-center identification for the conformal net. The extra annulus normalization in A1 is still needed for complete unitarity of the VOA, its specified unitary ribbon structure, and the chosen $\mathcal{H}_3$ VOA extension. In particular, the diagonal net theory and its character interpretation have a weaker dependency than the chosen unitary VOA extension. The earlier synthesis sources are `hi_cft_20260923_c8two_final_theorem.md` and `hi_cft_20260923_c8two_certificate_audit.md`; their unqualified analytic conclusion is replaced here by the remaining specific annulus hypothesis and the proved intermediate reductions.

13 Relation to the proposed Haagerup theories

Albert–Honda–Kaidi–Zheng explicitly assume the existence of a $c = 8$ Haagerup-center theory in Section II, footnote 4 of [4]. Their equation (12) displays the γ-dependent characters, and their extension discussion relates the center theory to the E_8 theory with Haagerup defects.

Under the stated construction inputs, Theorem 1.3 supplies a $\gamma = 0$ realization as a conformal net and a diagonal full net theory. Under the additional annulus comparison, Theorem 1.4 supplies the completely unitary VOA realization and a compatible E_8 VOA extension. The distinction between U-preserving and full-E_8-preserving defects is maintained. Neither this construction nor that finite gauging identifies the continuum limit of the ρ-projector chain. Section III of the cited paper proposes further asymmetric quotients towards charges two and six; those require additional conformal and defect data. No uniqueness theorem for all central-charge-eight CFTs is asserted here.

The ambient lattice is also compatible with the conditional characterization in [5, Section 4.3]: a rational chiral algebra with the Haagerup center at central charge eight must arise from a rank-two hypergroup action on $E_{6,1} \otimes A_{2,1}$. That characterization constrains a realization; it does not supply its generating fields. Conversely, the concrete inclusion constructed here does not identify the original extension's fusion category as $\mathcal{H}_3$ without the separate distinction between $\mathcal{H}_2$ and $\mathcal{H}_3$ discussed above. Keeping these two statements separate avoids making an existence argument depend on a desired choice of Morita representative.

A Certificate ledger and reproducibility

The following frozen records supply the finite construction inputs. The revision of 27 September 2026 additionally reran the original provenance check, minimal generation, grade-two exact OPE and PCT checks, the exact grade-three construction, and the final Gate 4, charged-span, and Gate 5 verifiers. Fresh outputs were written under `c8_revision_20260927/`; the frozen inputs were not overwritten. All paths are relative to the project directory. The filenames preserve an unambiguous connection to the actual records.

Result	Record and scope
Minimal generation	`hi_cft_20260923_c8_minimal_generators.json`: the short generating set in (1) generates all 120 vectors of S_2. This necessary provenance step was absent from the original 640-file bundle and is explicitly included in the supplemented ledger.
Initial spaces	`hi_cft_20260923_c8_exact_unitary_certificate.json` and `hi_cft_20260923_c8_grade3_exact_v2.json`: PCT, stress and singular OPE identities, and exact dimension 956.
Lower identities	`hi_cft_20260923_next_structure_lower_closure.json`: 3,970 exact relations.
Actual triplet	`hi_cft_20260923_next_structure_p4_controls.json`: 18 current-zero and six direct Virasoro controls.
Raising saturation	`hi_cft_20260923_c8two_structure_saturation.json`: 644 exact images in a quotient of dimension 322.
Additional direct seeds	`hi_cft_20260923_c8two_targeted_h4_trimmed_v2/summary.json`: 118 completed exact identities. The unfinished final block in this historical directory is not counted as a completed identity.
Raised seeds	`hi_cft_20260923_c8two_structure_h4_raised_exact/summary.json`: twelve additional ordinary exact identities.
Singlet premise	`hi_cft_20260923_c8two_h4_singlet_premise_verified.json`: all 24 raising conditions replayed.
Projected residuals	`hi_cft_20260923_c8two_h4_singlet_exact.json`: twelve full exact residuals, using 21 selected columns.
Full Gate 4	`hi_cft_20260923_c8two_gate4_verified.json`: all 2,898 identities, using singlet recovery and raising saturation.
Charged spanning	`hi_cft_20260923_c8two_charged_span_verified.json`: 28 reconstructed seeds, rank 322, and current commutators.
Full Gate 5	`hi_cft_20260923_c8two_gate5_verified.json`: all 24 channels by the stated Jacobi argument.
Combined provenance	`hi_cft_20260923_c8two_proof_bundle.json`: 640 authenticated files, including earlier exact inputs and proof notes. It checks provenance and completion, not formal correctness of every mathematical argument.

The final Gate 4 verifier replays the twelve projected identities using integer-cleared coefficients, separately from the rational producer. A field element is represented in the basis $1, s, t, st$, with $s^2 = 13$, $t^2 = -3$; all residuals are exact four-component rational identities. Prime calculations are used to select candidate columns and to certify positive spanning against an independently known upper dimension. A vanishing prime residual alone is never treated as a characteristic-zero containment proof.

The provenance-ledger replay can be written to a fresh output without changing the original certificate:

```
python hi_cft_safe_run.py --limit-mib 1024 -- \
  python hi_cft_20260923_c8two_proof_bundle.py \
  --output /tmp/haagerup-c8-proof-review.json
```

These lines represent a single shell command. The output path must not already exist. This rechecks the frozen source hashes and completion flags; it does not rerun all original mode

calculations. The source files of the individual certificate producers and verifiers are bound into the same ledger.

A.1 Fresh replay coverage

The supplemented ledger `c8_revision_20260927/finite_input_ledger_final.json` retains the original provenance graph and explicitly binds the minimal-generation and exact grade-three records. This repairs an omission in the original bundle's declared roots; it does not modify the old bundle or infer a mathematical identity from a hash. The principal fresh outputs are listed below. A "replay" means the specific operation in the right column, rather than a full independent reconstruction of every earlier lattice calculation.

Output under `c8_revision_20260927/`	Recomputed assertion
`provenance_replay.json`	All 640 original source hashes and required completion flags agree.
`minimal_generators_replay.json`	The specified short generating set gives the whole exact 120-dimensional S_2.
`unitary_replay.json`	The PCT, stress, primarity and grade-two singular-product tests, including all eight primary multiplets, pass in the exact coefficient field.
`grade3_replay.json`	The characteristic-zero generated span has dimension 956, with normal subspace of dimension 634.
`gate4_replay.json`	Integer-cleared projected residuals, raising premises and saturation establish all $2,898$ required Gate 4 inputs.
`charged_span_replay.json`	The reconstructed charged seeds and lowering images span dimension 322; the saved current matrices satisfy both axis and cross-axis commutators.
`gate5_replay.json`	Exact quotient relations, nonzero bottom coefficients and authenticated inputs support all 24 channels of the printed Jacobi deduction.
`top_bound_replay.json`	Independent rational enumeration reconstructs all fourteen core tops, trace coefficients, the two current-character inequalities and the 17/10 certificate.
`core_extension_replay.json`	The zero-complementary-energy space in S_2 has dimension 25 and contains all six required order-thirteen spectral witnesses with their exact eigenvalues.
`top81_replay.json`	In each of four mixed lattice sectors, exact zero-mode actions and weighted adjoints generate the entire 81-dimensional top from a unique Cartan eigenline.
`potts_replay.json`	The explicit Potts primary has the required stress action and lies in the actual generated S_3.
`pf13_membership_replay.json`	The parafermion candidate lies in the generated Cartan-zero S_3, its PCT line is stable, and the positive stress identity has the stated exact coefficients.

The last two producers originally had fixed output paths. The adapter `c8_revision_20260927/replay_structural_input.py` redirects only that output construction to a fresh file, requires exactly one write, and compares the complete mathematical output with the frozen record, excluding timing and memory statistics. It authenticates the unchanged producer and checks that the original record remains unchanged. The parafermion polynomial OPE and decoupling records are authenticated inputs, not claimed as newly reconstructed by this membership replay.

These calculations ran serially with at most two compute threads and CPU affinity enforced. The permanent shared-desktop guard imposed a 6 GiB address ceiling, an 8 GiB process-group RSS watchdog and a 32 GiB host-available-memory reserve; the exact lattice replays used smaller address caps of at most 2 GiB. The grade-three replay took about 493 seconds and peaked at 0.190 GiB sampled group RSS. No swap capacity was included in the allocation budget. Per-job estimates and logs are recorded in `c8_revision_20260927/resource_review.md`.

B Limited formalization

Two new Lean files isolate implications that are useful independently of the VOA implementation. They use the existing Lean 4.33.1 and Mathlib 4.33.1 environment and were checked without `sorry` or new axioms. The axiom reports contain only Lean's standard propositional extensionality, quotient soundness and, for some statements, classical choice.

1. `lean/HaagerupIzumi/CFT/FiniteClosure.lean` proves raising saturation for a stable submodule, under an explicit joint nilpotence hypothesis. It also proves recovery from a projected residual and the abstract linear Jacobi-bottom-witness implication. The hypotheses identify exactly where the current-representation bounds and finite identities enter the manuscript's use of these lemmas.

2. `lean/HaagerupIzumi/CFT/TopBound.lean` proves the displayed fourteen-variable deficit identity and derives the cleared-denominator 17/10 inequality from nonnegative multiplicities and the two stated $\mathfrak{sl}_2$ inequalities. The independent rational checker separately reconstructs the table to which this identity is applied.

The safe compiler commands, issued serially from the project root, are

```
python lean/safe_lean.py \
  lean/HaagerupIzumi/CFT/FiniteClosure.lean
python lean/safe_lean.py \
  lean/HaagerupIzumi/CFT/TopBound.lean
```

The driver invokes the same resource guard. These formalizations do not define a VOA, validate the lattice engine, prove filtered Wick reduction, construct the embedded parafermion factor, or resolve A1. Their value is to check the stated algebraic implications with their premises exposed, rather than to certify the entire manuscript.

C Compilation and review scope

The main source is `hi_cft_c8_proof.tex`; its companion sources are `hi_cft_c8_manuscript_structure.tex` and `hi_cft_c8_manuscript_analytic.tex`, with references in `hi_cft_c8_bibliography.tex`. Run `pdflatex` twice on the main source for cross-references

and the table of contents. The document uses standard TeX packages and requires no shell escape.

The frozen computational records remain unchanged. Fresh replays, the supplemented provenance ledger and the two Lean modules are additional checks with the scopes stated above. The original ledger does not authenticate this revised exposition. The remaining analytic comparison and the exact embedded-field inputs should be examined directly when assessing the conditional VOA conclusion; neither a successful PDF build nor a modular-character match resolves them.

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